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Bildungsroman Lecture Notes (1)

Conclusion

Bildungsroman

- Bildungsroman is never normative
- Critics assert that Bildungsroman is about showing how individuals mature and achieve autonomous coherent ideas by curbing unruly desires
- Critics wrong, cherry picking examples that are exceptions not rules
- Most Bildungsromans are not about how individuals develop on their own, about how they develop through relationships, individuals, and communities
- Many Bildungsromans are about people who never achieve coherence
- Should coherence be goal of maturation?
    - SM says no → coherence is stasis
    - development means being able to grow and change
    - Baldwin doesn't end Go Tell it On the Mountain with saying "ive arrived" he ends with perpetual present "im coming"
    - most of books we read end in present tense or opening up to the future
- If we understand Bildungsroman as being about change and growth then we can see:
    - Wollstonecraft's ***revolutionary Bildungsroman*** is classic Bildungsroman - changes herself by abandoning social coherence and norms
        - begins with marriage ending
        - character goes on to try and change world by challenging the law
        - not a novel about one individual

        - novel is as much Jemima's story
        - exegesis → Jemima has priority tells story first
    - Pere Goriot encounter ***capitalist bildung*** which is about change volatility precarity competition and quantification, people desperately fighting each other for place on ladder
        - still not the story of any one individual
        - not about social cohesion
        - about how desire to succeed destabilizes relationships and individual
    - Jane Eyre depicts ***liberal bildung*** which is closest to classic bildung, controls unruly desires and freely chooses to embrace conventional norms
        - mad woman in the attic → presence suggests jane has to displace wildness onto racialized other
    - Kafka and The Metamorphosis has two ways of seeing book → surreal version of adolescence as liminal state, to turn into adult one passes into stage full of transformations you cant control, anti-bildungsroman because Gregor loses humanity and identity
        - also ways to read it that pushes us to realize selfhood that doesn't have consciousness and agency, grounded in the body
        - what makes us have self is other peoples recognition
    - Go Tell it On the Mountain shows **spiritual bildung**
        - John's self emerges in conflict and communion with his family and church
        - Racism obstructs Bildung by limiting opportunities for development and growth over many generations
        - Naturalism - emphasizes failure falling dirt, mode that expresses pessimism about progress
        - Novel counters naturalism with extended description of spiritual experience of being born again

        - John lifted by fellow church goers into time outside history and makes contact with higher being
    - Sula and ***existential bildung***, how do we give life meaning in face of inevitable pain and death
        - Sula - hyper individual who rejects conventional morality and everything else
        - Sula character represents nihilist bildung
        - example of exhilarating freedom and impossibility of existing for long
        - what it might be to grow without limits
        - Sula novel is magical realist experiment in character
        - Morrison challenging individual presence of Bildungsroman
    - The Woman Warrior and ***diasporic bildung*** using postmodern play of genres to explore what it means to come of age within between and outside certain cultures, acquiring voice overcoming fear and seeing parent as separate person in own right
    - Never Let Me Go has ***dystopian bildung*** (similar to the metamorphosis) what we get is generic building blocks of Bildungsroman, what will happen if you took characters going through typical things and put them in world that deprives them of key elements of humanity - having parents, choosing to have kids, not knowing exactly when and how we will die which gives sense of life being open ended, he strips away conventional aspects of personhood and says what can remain sustains personhood in face of no social recognition and family and regular relationship to life and death, memory and storytelling remain in face of these thigns
    - Conversations with Friends has **aristocratic bildung** (outside and inside) ***actorly bildung***, ***spiritual bildung, bourgieose bildung, emotional bildung*** (identify and sit with feelings), communal bildung
- Take away - own relationship to what it means to grow up
- Can’t live life in orderf

Novels

- Diegesis and exegesis
- Free indirect discourse
- Naturalism
- Realism
- Postmodernism
- Magical Realism
- Kafkaesque Surrealism
- Close reading
- Anaphora
- Apostrophe
- Connecting close readings to arguments about works as a whole
- Tracing motifs across novels

Book 7: The Woman Warrior

- Book has subtitle of memoir but not like memoir anyone thinks of and also has fiction
- Book has genre confusion - is it real? is it fiction? whose memoir is it? who is subject?
- If you're confused about these things you are reading the novel correctly
- Confusion about how different pieces of it connect → postmodern style
- Postmodernism - aesthetic about fragmentation and disorientation and refusing wholeness
- Why is she doing this and why did this book get assigned?
- Diasporic bildung and immigrant bildung
    - What does it mean to mature in culture different from your parents who are split
    - Disconnection that occurs

- Cannot fully access culture of parents either
- Have to figure out how to pull it together but it will never be whole as if you grew up in same culture as parents

[Book 7] 7.1 Maxine Hong Kingston + Background on The Woman Warrior

- Born in Stockton, California - central california - in 1940
- Still lives and writes in california
- Thinks of herself as Californian writer
- Parents born in China, dad arrived 1924 mom arrived much later
- Hong Kingston grew up speaking Chinese at home and became fluent in English in Kindegarten
- Got BA from Berkeley in 1960s - participated in free speech and protest etc
- Protested heavily against Vietnam War
- Throughout career has been very preoccupied with pacifism and return home
- Majored in English, also considered journalism and engineering
- Moved to Hawaii after some time in California
- Teaching English in high school in Hawaii when wrote Woman Warrior published at age 36
- Like Pere Goriot and Jane Eyre and 20th century books → commercial success and critical success
- On bestseller list and never went out of print
- Used to be one of the most widely taught books in courses
- Less common now
- Easily dissectable, easily anthologizable
- Book is taught in many different kinds of courses - literature, american studies, ethnic studies, women and gender studies, anthropology, history

[Book 7] 7.2 Genre Confusion

- Won national book critic award for nonfiction → thats nuts
- Hong Kingston insists not meant to be biography or memoir
- Sharon Marcus feels strongly that the book is a work of fiction
- We never know the narrator's name - interesting that first chapter called No Name Woman
- If we are going to call it memoir need to acknowledge that it breaks rules of memoir
- What are rules of memoir?
  - Typically focuses on single person's life, usually ends with when that person has achieved advance adulthood
    - Exemplary memoir in US tradition - Autobiography of Benjamin Franklin by Benjamin Franklin
      - work that creates template for memoir as story
      - about his upward mobility, self reliance, and good habits
      - very much about how Ben Franklin is like US itself
      - in reading it people thought they could emulate him
    - Woman Warrior breaks form this
      - Woman Warrior → over half the text is about her mother, other parts about aunts
      - Girlhood among ghosts applies to both her and mother
      - Even title woman warrior could refer to multiple people
  - Typically give some background on parents and spend a few chapters on childhood
  - Aim to convey how life is unified organic whole
- Woman warrior of second chapter is narrator's fantasy of inserting herself into myth

[Book 7] 7.3 White Tigers (Chapter 2) - Not Linear Time

- Legendary time starts on pg 22 → old man and woman come out, references to natural world and scene but no idea where we are in time and place, very cosmic, lot of shifting rapidly between past and present and all of time collapsing into single moment
    - pg 27 “watching centuries pass in moments because suddenly I understand time which is fixed like the north star” → occupying all moments of time simultaneously
    - couple who is training narrator to be warrior but sometimes old married couple sometimes young sometimes siblings
    - narrator grafting two myths together - Mulan + folk hero Yue Fei (characters carved into back like tattoo)
    - pg 45 in this section abrupt break → instead of leaving out whole event (as Morrison does with Sula and Jude affair) we are thrown out of legendary time into realist time → “my american life has been such a disappointment” → no outlet for being warrior but told to be warrior, did well in school but told to save village but didn’t even know what village was
        - everything confusing about this book shown here
        - what is the village? - town mother lived in, where she lives with her parents
        - doesn’t know what village is so doesn’t know what self to be or what form heroism should take
        - interestingly legendary world is what grounds her firmly in set of values
        - american life is where she gets disoriented and doesn’t know what action should be
    - Full of completed circles that represent boundary and harmony
        - pg 23 - I learned to move fingers hand head and feet in circles, when she battles she spins green and silver circles all around her, her army brings order → circles bring order

[Book 7] 7.4 No Name Woman (Chapter 1) - Not Linear Time

- Mother recalling aunt's story as cautionary tale when narrator gets period
- Several points where shift to present tense
- Toggles between what she knows about her aunt (almost nothing) and conjecture which then become assertions
- Thinking about multi generational households, speculation about country she's never been to in time before she was born, connection to present life
- Reader is just being tossed around
- pg 16 conclude in present tense in the present moment - aunt haunts me, devoted pages of paper to aunt, tells reader that she heard story 20 years ago → saying she's about 33 or 34 and still thinking about her aunt
- Haunted time - time you can't separate into linear order, none of this is conducive to typical memoir
- None of this is typical of memoir, once you get going you move forward
- Woman Warrior structure been compared to braided knot
- Form of the knot, looping, twisting, turning is connection to Never Let Me Go also shows circle motif in woman warrior
- More than one kind of circle
- Opening section all about broken circles
    - When the villagers destroy aunt's family home they are giving physical representation of break she made in roundness of community
    - Aunt's pregnancy (rounding) breaks circle
    - Rupture of circle
- Sections of book comment on each other

[Book 7] 7.5 Confusion in Reading The Woman Warrior

- What changes in book as it goes along? - to some extent becomes more realistic but the final section returns to legend
- Many argue book returns to where it started at the end

- Preoccupation with supernatural throughout, not typical of memoir
- Book is not interested in social and historical contexts (confused about this)
- Hong Kingston cites “5th Chinese Daughter” as influence, about someone growing up in SF opens with description of SF chinatown that is typical of memoir - gives context with real landmarks and then goes into family that is situated in neighborhood in city in continent
- Hong Kingston never sets the scene that way
- Trying to convey experience of not really understanding what context exactly is
- Woman Warrior sometimes moves into anthropological voice, sometimes voice is personal and subjective → makes it confusing
- What narrator is doing is trying to fill in blanks of her mother’s stories
- Trying to make sense of mother’s voice
- As you read book understand that there is no alignment with central character or genre
- Talk about postmodernism next lecture

[Book 7] 7.6 Genre Play

- End of woman warrior narrator lists ways she might understand what it means to be Chinese American
  - “I continue to sort out what’s just my childhood, just my imagination, just my family, just the village, just movies, just living.” (205)
  - List emulates structure of woman warrior itself in heterogeneity and multiplicity
  - List spans singular and multiple → shifts from personal to collective
  - List alternates between factual and fictional
  - Book argues living takes place between factual and fictional
- Implicit argument is that we cannot untangle fact and fiction

- Fact-based → oral history, ethnography, medical discourse in Shaman, personal essay, autobiography of women of color
- Fiction-based → myth and legend, ghost stories, chinese opera, classical chinese poetry, chinese martial arts films, comic books, california tales, kunstlerroman
- Novel is hybrid genre but this is a lot of genres to combine
- Combining this many genres involves breaking rules
- Outlaw text that contests stereotypes of asian american at time when US culture was shifting from criminalizing asian americans towards moving to model minority
- In refusal to affiliate herself with that idea, Hong Kington is affiliating herself with literary mode whose rule is not to follow rules → postmodernism

[Book 7] 7.7 Postmodernism

- Narrator ends outburst at end of book by rejecting mother's tendency to blur fact and fiction
- However the book is blend of fact and fiction which describes book's adoption of a postmodern aesthetic
- Postmodernism emerged from modernism and is associated with period from 1960s - 1990s
- Thomas Pynchon, John Barth, John Foster Wallace
- Philip Roth, Margaret Atwood, Ishmael Reed, Sandra Cisneros, Zadie Smith, Salman Rushdie have written postmodern works
- Postmodernism emphasizes pluralism, hybridity, and heterogeneity, postmodern works have been described as heteroglossic and polyphonic because they assemble a multiplicity of divergent perspectives voices and discourses
- Postmodern fiction can sound cacophonous in attempt to capture overwhelming variety of speech and language

- Focus on mother and aunt alongside narrator creates fragmented autobiography that foregrounds storytelling itself as crucial element of bildung → story of self emerges through telling other people's stories
- Postmodern emphasis on pluralism is seen in Shaman when two versions of mother's night confronting ghost and At the Western Palace when mother imagines ways sister's confrontation might unfold
- Postmodern hybridity involves pastiche - pasting together multiple genres in single work in way that might involve parody and resembles collage
    - White Tigers → narrator grafts myth of Yue Fei onto Fa Mu Lan and combines imagery from Chinese landscape painting and motifs from martial arts films
    - White tigers → combines legend situated in distant past with narrator's present American life
    - Also describes form of the Woman Warrior as a whole since 5 chapters are different and not chronological
- Overview of book's sections and general affiliations
    - No Name Woman → oral history
    - White Tiger → legends
    - Shaman → maternal biography, interspersing medical education with supernatural encounters, ends with discussion between mother and daughter close to time of writing
    - At the Western Palace → most realistic linear account of events taking place, folds literary fiction in
    - Song for a Barbarian Reed Pipe → meta-pastiche, recapitulates structure of work as a whole by combining multiple time periods and perspectives and mingling real occurrences with supernatural encounters and retellings of legends
- Postmodernism emphasizes indeterminacy, discontinuity, and playfulness
- Postmodernism often involves metafictional event - as much about how story gets told as story itself, oven highlights narrator's voice

    - Woman warrior is metafictional because it tells the story of how the character acquired the ability to narrate the story we read
- Postmodernists believe that everything is fiction - all knowledge
- No Name Woman adopts postmodernist approach by:
    - Telling aunt's story multiple times
    - Adopting polyphonic form that combines narrator's voice with her mother's while imagining
    - Deploying heteroglossic style that pastiches or collages variety of discourses: the oral and the literary, the ethnographic, novelistic and autobiographical
    - Asserting the constructed, fictional qualities of a factual event by toggling between conjecture and assertion

[Book 7] 7.8 Diasporic/Immigrant Bildung + Postmodernism

- The Woman Warrior combines immigrant and diasporic Bildung because narrator is so involved with her mother whose experience as an immigrant is a crucial element of the narrator's maturation as a child of diaspora
- As diasporic subject, narrator inhabits multiple worlds and shuttles between them
- Result is postmodern sensibility that expresses narrator's uncertainty about what is real and what is made up
- Narrator does not present her life and world as organic whole, formulates her self and her narrative as braids, loops, and knots
- Diasporic Bildungsromans - stories about person coming of age whose parents have migrated from one country to another and often from one language to another, person grows up in different country than parents
- 5 tropes common among diasporic bildung that occur in each section of The Woman Warrior
    - 1) Emphasis on survival

        - other types of bildungsromans often take basic securities for granted and therefore focus on protagonist's desire for adventure, creativity, and romance
        - diasporic bildungsromans foreground basic security as primary goal
        - diasporic parenting often frames education as admonition or warning
        - diasporic child does not simply imbibe parents' wisdom - she must interpret it
        - diasporic child has benefit of independence from parents but also premature maturity of not being able to assume one's parents know world better than child
    - 2) Difficulty pinpointing frame of reference by which to measure development, maturation, and growth
        - "I could not figure out what was my village" (45) towards end of white tigers
        - diasporic subject has difficulty identifying frame of reference that would define what counts as maturity, success, and full development as a person
    - 3) Diasporic subject is a subject in and of translation
        - Shaman - mother makes her haggle at department store
        - Narrator dreams of flying between continents → flying is version of translation
        - Carries this out with asking pharmacist for candy
        - Narrator knows what is happening - pharmacist gives candy out of pity but mother things its compensation for insult
    - 4) As subject in translation, diasporic subject often seen as excessive or lacking
        - At the Western Palace - aunt observes directness of children's gazes and asks why daughters aren't more demure
        - Chinese american girls barely speaking because perceive chinese women as being loud

- 5) Diasporic bildung generates ambivalence about maturation
    - “sometimes they scorn us for having had it so easy, and sometimes they’re delighted.”
    - parents feel that children not having had to struggle are weak
    - but parents also feel that children having had it easy is good because they have secured children’s future
    - both scorn and delight are effort to assert parental superiority in face of situation that inverts parent-child hierarchy by giving children born in US advantage over parents born outside it
    - ambivalence also results from fact that children’s successes in US distances them from parents born elsewhere

[Book 7] 7.9 Recap of Written Lecture

- Woman Warrior is text that deliberately combines genres
- Analogy to character experiencing the challenge of growing up in cultures that conflict with each other
- Talked about how book’s approach to genre relate to novel’s commitment to postmodern aesthetic
- 5 key features of diasporic bildung
    - 1) Emphasis on survival
    - 2) Difficulty pinpointing a frame of reference by which to measure maturation, development, and growth
    - 3) The diasporic subject is a subject in and of translation
        - focus on translation as key to developing selfhood
        - end of Shaman when narrator imagines herself flying between space and she learns to fly between languages and cultures
            - flying is important because when you fly you are above and see everything, not immersed

- 4) As a subject in translation, the diasporic subject is often seen as excessive
  or lacking
    - example → being quiet, in her culture chinese women very loud so in attempting to adjust there is an overcorrection where the girls have become too quiet in order to be like white american girls
    - cultural values are relative
      - easy to take cultural value for granted when only 1 culture to reference (seen in Jane Eyre)
- 5) Diasporic Bildung generates ambivalence about maturation (both for parents and children)
    - as youth grows up in new culture become farther/alienated from parents

- Divide rhythm of book with when narrator is inside and outside family
- Final chapter is recap of style theme etc of earlier chapter

[Book 7] 7.10 Ghosts and Warriors

- Title - The Woman Warrior: Memoir of a Girlhood Among Ghosts
  - criticism that by calling it woman warrior suggests warrior normally man
  - can read White Tiger and Song for a Barbarian Reed Pipe as corrective of this myth
  - another reading - instead of contrasting woman warrior to man warrior, woman warrior is being contrasted with girlhood
    - about how girlhood among ghosts turns someone into woman warrior
    - developmental narrative is girl → woman
    - implicit question - but how?, this is the question the book indirectly answers
  - presence of word ghost in title

        - suggests difference between childhood and adulthood has something to do with ghosts
        - because woman is equated with warriordom, **thesis is woman is girl who has warred with ghosts** (can also say adult is a child who has warred with ghosts)
- This thesis gives explanation for why Shaman is middle section of book
    - diegesis and exegesis so mismatched
    - overcoming ghost is central theme
- What do ghosts represent?
    - white, foreign
    - outside narrator's frame of reference
    - manifestation of fear, people that narrator is taught to be afraid of
    - caught between worlds, living and dead, human and nonhuman
    - folklore
- Focus on how ghosts represent fear?
    - pg 67 mother decided to stay overnight in the room, decides to overcome fear, tells them if the next morning they find she is afraid "tweak my ears, call my name, and tell me how to get home"
        - interesting command because character not named
        - interesting mention of ear as well
        - book that emphasizes speech and quiet but not necessarily listening
    - what does it meant to war with a ghost? → to war with own fear
    - book is invested in reality of how people feel about ghosts
    - being a warrior means learning to act in spite of fear (explains how book can be called this when Hong-Kingston is pascifist)
    - one definition of bildung the book offers is confronting what you fear (common in YA adventure fantasy but not in realism)
- How does book relate to voice and speech?

    - final section has narrator describing at great length unhappiness with own voice
    - narrator bullying other chinese american girl by ordering her to speak → displacing and projecting onto this girl
        - carryover from aunt
    - confession scene where narrator tries to tell mother all the things she's done wrong → idea about speaking about things you've done wrong as part of growing up
    - major outburst and makes clear narrator has misunderstood her parents
    - final story is about woman finding voice about translating between cultures
- Suggests that bildung involves following
    - acquiring voice
    - learning to say no (refusal to internalize harmful norms)
    - learning to use voice to recognize cultural frameworks (translator)
    - diasporic subjects acquire voice by telling stories that translate well
    - not just about reconciling conflicting frameworks but finding language that bridges them

[Book 7] 7.11 Bildung and Relationship to Mother

- Book equates growing up and maturing with a warrior
- Book says to be an adult is to be a warrior
- Hong Kingston doesn't define warrior as defeats others but overcoming own fears
- Book is more about mother than narrator
- Need to set aside child's frustration with mother to see what narrator is really saying about her
- First thing about mother is that mother offers narrator model of fearlessness

    - mother/brave orchid defeats ghosts
- Narrator has fears about her mother
    - Fear that mother doesn't love her, that she thinks she's not worth feeding, fears that mother won't let go of her but also that she will hold too close
    - Daughter is haunted by mother → therefore daughter must be warrior to overcome mother
- One way to think about arc is mother learning to grapple with mother's ghostly presence
    - Mother's ghost is like sitting ghost it weighs the child down
    - Like sitting ghost mother's ghostly presence also rouses child
    - Important to differentiate perception of mother from narrator as child
- Character and narrator aren't the same
- Narrator represents character at the point when they're matured
    - Ex Jane Eyre character is either 10 or 18, narrator is 30, never 30 year old character
    - Same thing with woman warrior
    - Narrator has had to go through bildung to write book we are reading
    - Question is what has narrator had to learn to be able to write this book
    - Narrator has to learn to see mother as separate person in own right in order for narrator to mature into person who can write book
    - Narrator must learn that parents are separate from her and growing and changing
    - pg 200 narrator acquires theory of mind for her mother → how does this person think that isn't about me or like how I think, and she gets this here
        - paragraph break is what is significant here
        - doesn't run mother and herself together
        - paragraph break is sign of growth in child
        - sign of growth from child to narrator

        - narrator doesn’t suppress what she felt → gives whole paragraph to them
        - then there is break that is also a connection
        - in what follows narrator can also hold on to what her mother felt which had nothing to do with her
        - these things conflict and narrator can now hold on to both of those at same time

[Book 7] 7.12 Structural Analysis → how Woman Warrior tells its story

- No Name Woman
    - toggles between quoting mother in quotation marks and replacing mothers words with her own
    - in this suggestion as if narrator can only acquire voice by combatting mother’s voice or erasing mother’s voice
    - changes a lot even in next section
- White Tigers
    - narrator retelling story that her mother told her
    - as child she walked around house singing this story with her mother
    - tells story that fleshes out this story
    - not contradicting the story her mother told her, she’s inhabiting it
    - narrator is incorporating mother’s voice and that gives her voice she can speak with even more fully
    - no real contradiction between story she tells and mother tells
- Shaman
    - first time mother gets name
    - quite far into section when mother is named
    - mother is not named as brave orchid until after she has fought the ghosts

- this means book equates fighting and confronting ghost with fuller voice
- first section to use free indirect discourse
- Free Indirect Discourse - famous for use in Jane Austen, rare in first person narration, saw it in Kafka
  - free direct discourse merges voice of character with voice of narrator
  - direct discourse - quote
  - indirect discourse - “she thought”, reported exclusively by narrator, presented like narrator hears what character says, she thought is there for clarity and to establish separation between narrator and character
  - free indirect discourse - characters inner thoughts blending perfectly with narrators voice so both of them merge and separateness falls out of view
    - few kind of grammar that only exists in literature because of presumption of narration
    - depends on narrators ability to enter characters mind and render thoughts verbatim while simultaneously acknowledging by use of third person that narrator and character are separate
    - simultaneously communicates connection and separation between reporter and other person
- only here in this section that narration acknowledges closeness to mother and separateness from mother → they understand each other well enough for this to work
- this section has longest conversation with mother and daughter, no screaming no stories
  - a lot of what their dialog is about is mutual misunderstanding
  - pg 108 - mother accepts daughters independence
  - pg 201 daughter has outburst says she cant stay anymore
  - in diegesis (order of when things unfold in story) happens in middle but exegesis at the end

        - mother is responding to daughter saying she wants to get out of here into peaceful understanding
        - significant that after mother says better for you to stay away narrator says a weight lifted from me
        - we are meant to think of ghost that was sitting on her mother
        - this is parallel moment for daughter, weight of burden mother was placing on her has lifted
        - daughter begins to be less haunted by her mother
- At the Western Palace
    - fascinating from point of view of how story manages relationship to mother
    - in the narration, at the western palace is so much about mother being separate person
    - daughter wasn't even present
    - everything in at the western palace is just about mother
    - this is chapter where mother gets to exist apart from daughter in narrative terms
    - also section focuses least on brave orchid as mother
    - focuses on brave orchid as a daughter sister and wife
- Song for a Barbarian Reed Pipe
    - only section to connect directly to last one
    - first section that starts to bridge sections
    - has something to do with daughter and mother being able to bridge their relationship
    - chapter ends by describing poet able to bridge two cultures
    - "the beginning is hers, the ending, mine" → places emphasis on narrator, not symmetry

    - whole final section is not about daughter overwriting mother's story or voicing mothers story, this one is a collaboration
    - final story is about how to bridge cultures
    - daughter and mother have stopped warring with each other - sign of growth for both

narrator saying child view of chinese culture distorted not narrator view, find evidence for that and use it

Book 6: Never Let Me Go

- Readers feel what students of Hailsham feel when reading the book
- Narrator constantly moving around in time
- Above all narrator is trying to communicate to us what things felt like in the past rather than everything she knows at the moment
- Kazuo Ishiguro
    - Born in 1954
    - Winner of nobel prize
    - Born in Japan moved to Britain when he was 5

[Book 6] 6.1 Dystopian Bildungsroman

- Bildungsroman is about what it means to develop into fully matured person
- Foundational question - what counts as a person?
- Novel tackles both questions - what it means to mature and what it means to be a person
- Most of all asking the question - how do those denied full personhood mature?
- Typical coming of age connects maturation to family
    - Come from family and form your own family (especially in contemporary fiction)

    - Acquiring some independence from your parents, financial or residential while remaining connected to them in some way
    - Maturation = learning to recognize parents in their own right
    - Sometimes means acknowledging harm parents caused and learning to move on (Francis in Conversations with Friends does this)
    - Same arc informed Go Tell it On The Mountain - narrator's focus on John's elders throughout the novel is how we recognize that they are people with their own stories (sense that John finds this out eventually)
    - Learn to develop relationship with parents that is connected and also separate
- This element is not completely missing from Never Let Me Go
    - Characters don't have parents
    - Transfers some of this sense of learning that adults are separate to the teachers "guardians" which is parental term
    - We learn about guardians towards the end just as the characters do
- Bildungsroman made coupling and reproduction the ultimate measure of maturity
    - Jane Eyre most clearly takes on this aspect
    - Nel a little bit too but shows marriage plot does not offer fairytale ending
- Never Let Me Go is a dystopian Bildungsroman
    - Ishiguro is doing thought experiment on what happens if you strip away narrative structure - no parents
    - Last names is often sign of link to parents - "Kathy H", last names in the book often abbreviated to initial → her name is actually "Kathy H." because last name of clone is kept private...
    - "Kathy H." presents Kathy's self as fragmented, clones will have to provide organs and be stripped from their parts
    - Significant that last name is fragment
    - Characters have no parents and can't reproduce

    - Implication is that they've been engineered to be sterile (not automatic process of cloning) presumably to prevent ethical issues
    - Kept from their past and also from their future
    - Marriage and life partnership is complicated → not just way of expressing love but to prove humanity and live longer
    - No real path to coupledom in Bildungsroman sense of it - many of sexual interactions are short lived in way that is age appropriate and also condition of them being deprived of full humanity
    - Dystopia is usually reflection of the world we live in, typically highlighting aspects of the world we live in for thought experiment, for affect, as a political point
    - Lots of Bildungsroman are interested in how oppression works and thwarts development, also how do people thrive despite oppression
    - Characters in Never Let Me Go sort of fit with that but oppression is extraordinarily thorough - hints that school is basically prison (accidents, electric fence) and then brief years of freedom
    - Book lacks any possibility of choice and rebellion
    - Taking general shape of other characters lives in other books and making it absolute
- Another way book undoes Bildungsroman is shortening future, typically idea that we don't know what outcome will be but in this novel the characters arc of development is arrested by fact that they are under house arrest and they know that
    - What they do with that knowledge is different - in denial
    - More than most humans ever do they know how and when they will die
    - In this way conditions are different for them than for any other humans
    - Can't be an existential bildungsroman because its about uncertainty of how and when we die
    - Fundamental notion of being alive that we don't know how we die (if its of natural causes)

    - Evacuates the possibility of Bildung
- What is remarkable about this book is despite all of these things it is much like a traditional Bildungsroman
    - Novel that is running through classic tropes of coming of age novel
    - Opening part of the novel (while they are in Hailsham) belongs to sub-genre of coming of age - boarding school story (British) sent to school away from home at young age
        - Ishiguro evokes tropes of school story - hiding from teachers, finding nooks in school, late nights chatting in dorm
        - Teachers are stock types from boarding school tale
            - Warm and empathetic (Geraldine)
            - Brisk (Lucy)
            - Admirable and formidable headmistress (Emily)
        - Book opens with kids playing and being detective (like stranger things, nancy drew, hardy boys)
            - “meet me by the pond”
            - plot against teacher
    - Opening into substantive things that characters grapple with - desire to consume and acquire collections and sales
        - common experience of consumer culture not living up to the hype - what’s happening with the sales
        - what’s also happening is the stuff at these sales is that its the stuff no one wants, not even secondhand stores
    - Cliquishness and bullying
    - Listening to the same song over and over
    - Reading books watching videos about sex
    - Claiming to be having more sex than you’re actually having
    - Feeling like the odd one out for not having sex

    - Talking about books you haven’t read
    - Belief that going to special school like Hailsham would have power to change your life and make everything different for you
    - Characters copying mannerisms from television (bifocal approach)
        - takes on extra charge because these characters are doing it because they are deprived of being in outside world and seeing how it works
        - all humans are memetic we all learn how to be people by coping other people
        - but when defined by being a copy and cut off from world at large, when you do this copying of television it signifies a lack and sign of damage
    - Characters eagerness to be part of a couple (bifocal)
        - rumor that being in love delays your donations
        - resembles people trying for citizenship - proving your in love
        - in seeking this out resemble many characters
- Core elements of Never Let Me Go especially in beginning of novel are bridging classic dystopian bildungsroman and traditional bildungsroman
- First half is engaged with terms like growth, development, and change all over the place
    - pg 13 - Kathy has set herself challenge, part of phase she is going through at that time
    - pg 23 - Tommy says he has grown up a bit
    - chapter 2 & 3 - Tommy has to control tantrums and control himself
    - next section about ruth - how do you learn to separate reality from fantasy
        - start with Ruth’s horses
        - charting fantasy to reality that most children experience
        - challenge for ruth
        - secret guard to protect Geraldine

        - when students want to signify that they are maturing they break from it and reveal fantasy
- Bifocal nature of narrative - characters seem like characters you'd encounter anywhere but also set apart from other people

[Book 6] 6.2 Recap

- Never Let Me Go as dystopian bildungsroman with bifocal perspective which is used to give different world very different from our own to comment on things in our world
- Book published in 2005 but set in England 1990s - world that we're already in not what's to come
- Novels trips away key elements of Bildungsroman - having parents, being able to become a parent, Ishiguro does it to focus attention on other aspects of Bildungsroman that get diluted by family
    - managing emotions
    - managing relationship between fantasy and reality
        - Ishiguro fascinated with silence and denial and how people don't take in what's happening
            - minds always keeping things away as much as keeping things in
        - Kathy in relation to Ruth goes through another version of Bildung - what do you do when people close to you are deluded
    - How do you repair harm you've done to someone? (word repair comes up in pivotal moments)
    - learning about sex
- Bifocal narrative - read it as story about others and also about normals, what it is to know that we are all going to die and we don't pay attention to it, truncated and happening to people much younger
- Book is telling nostalgic story about school and also horror story about people sentenced to death → any human being dealing with knowledge that one day we will die

[Book 6] 6.3 Time + Narration

- Time is key element of bildungsroman because bildungsroman is about how people think about changing over time and how they actually do change and then reflect
- pg 77 kathy describing division between golden years and after
  - golden time because nothing changed or shifted, nothing to mark difference being 6 or 7 or 8
  - golden time therefore time when there is no awareness of time
  - also golden time because children are carefree
  - if childhood is golden time suggests adulthood is about decline
  - “impression of things changing rapidly around then like day turning to night”
  - talk with tommy was turning point - turning point of knowledge and awareness
- Kathy is framing adulthood as expulsion from Eden, equated with night → metaphor for death
- Kathy’s narration has layered structure constantly going back to before and after earlier and later → insistence on layering and chunking time
- Constant reminder than story is being narrated
- Diegesis (order in which things happen in story world) and exegesis (order in which narrator tells events) never align
- Kathy telling story of memories which rarely come to us sequentially
- What is the sequence of narration - decides to start telling story just before stops being carer and becomes donor, trying to make sense of her life before she dies
- Kathy tells story about evasion in an evasive way
- Mystery of why the students at Hailsham are encouraged to be creative
  - Kathy fabricates sense of mystery around something that isn’t a mystery to her to make us feel suspense as to whether main characters will escape

their fate, she knows they won't but waits until end of novel to answer question

- pg 260 Miss Emily explains art was taken to prove they had souls
  - Kathy asks who didn't think they had souls
  - Collision between how Kathy is perceived and her own sense of self (same with Madame as children)
  - In world of novel they have to prove they have souls but in our world they dont (we the reader all think they have souls)
  - Ishiguro achieves this by excluding normal perspective - never enter minds of guardians → this work of art (novel) has done what students art couldn't do, what Miss Emily couldn't do, show they have souls

- How has Ishiguro made us feel this way?
  - Interiority
  - Temporality
  - How does temporality of Kathy's narration affect interiority? How does it create person effect?
- 2 descriptions to answer this
  - Footpath that Kathy really loves
    - Little footpath that is personal to Kathy
    - Footpath is encompassing but backward facing
    - Followed all nooks and extensions
      - Nooks → many episodes of her focusing on conversation with two people
    - Looping approach to time
    - Mention of peering into windows like how Kathy's memories are episodes we peer into
  - Trip to Norfolk (midpoint of novel)
    - "sheer drop down to the sand" - seems like sheer drop to death

        - characters hope they can extend their time and instead of sheer drop they can dally and take zig zagging footpaths
        - “once you leant over the lane you could see zig zagging footpaths leading you from the clifface to the seafront”
- Novel has two types of chapters
    - Punctual chapters - land on specific moment and give that unit and are completed
        - almost no punctual chapters, just chapter 13, very short
            - heightens poignancy of last moment of freedom and hope - chapter about them being very much in the present
        - important as category because majority of novels has punctual chapters
    - Recursive chapters - shuttle back and forth between multiple time intervals
        - chapter 16 and 17 - layering flash forwards and flash backs
        - when does loop get closed?
        - talks about Kathy getting upset with Ruth for forgetting
        - then goes back to their conversation with the tapes
        - then churchyard with fight about tommy’s art
        - Kathy only returns to bus shelter in chapter 17
- Reason Ishiguro is doing this recursion stuff is to reinforce character’s persona
    - ability to knit past and presence together that creates personhood
    - can be very different person in the past but ability to remember that makes personhood
    - the more different moments you present the more it is a feat of memory and production of identity
    - memory confers personhood because it gathers disparate moments into unity → we like to think of people as both whole and complex

        - amoeba is definitely unit, just one cell but never think of as person because it is simple
        - human body creates personhood effect but not in this novel which emphasizes that the bodies unity can easily fall apart
- Unzipping = linear time, zig zagging = not linear time

[Book 6] 6.4 Connection to Literary History

- Ishiguro combines singular and iterative in most of chapters
- Kathy's narrative zig zags between iterative (events that happen many times but narrated only once) and singular (something happens once and gets described in great detail)
    - Kathy describing how she often thinks about her essay and then mentions telling Miss Emily about it once
- William Wordsworth - "spots of time" - past moment you find yourself returning to and vividly inhabiting, moment from past that stays with you for your whole life and when you return you feel like you're in it
    - Example - Norfolk Trip
- Marcel Proust - Remembrance of Things Past - interested in how things conjure memories, narrator soaks Madeleine in herbal tea and memories come flooding back
- What is Kathy's madeleine?
    - the tape?
    - the trip?

[Book 6] 6.5 Kathy's Madeleine → Judy Bridgwater Tape "Never Let Me Go"

- The tape bridges the gap separating Kathy's different life phases: Hailsham, cottages, carer narrating her past
- Pun on vertigo - clear allusion to Hitchcock's Vertigo - keep following woman in grey suit, in Vertigo that's what happens and woman is Madeleine but also Judy

- Kathy is looking for lost future with Tommy
- What the song represents for her is when she discovered her ruptured connection to future
- Norfolk - imagining where lost stuff goes
  - where Kathy goes at end of novel sees garbage collected
- Important in Proust → when memories are unlocked
- 169 and 171 → looking for tape that was lost but Tommy can't remember what it is called
- Unconscious element of memory that interested Proust - searching for things you can't remember
  - Kathy links decision to search for lost tape as a sudden change → every cloud blown away only fun and laughter
  - Amalgamation of Proust and Wordsworth
  - For Proust smell brings back memories and the defining characteristic of shop is odor, also voluntary effort does not produce tape, found suddenly by accident almost
  - Tape gives access to feeling of care-freeness (173)
- They are searching for the novel itself → tape has same name as novel
- Search for tape holds key to the novel, search for memory over which you don't have complete agency
- pg 166 Ruth has Norfolk represents hope of when lost something precious and looked and still couldn't find it didn't have to be completely heartbroken because when grown up could go find it again in Norfolk
- But what the grown up characters are searching for is not just lost past but also finding the loss of future
- Reconnecting with knowledge that what their life holds in store is being heartbroken

[Book 6] 6.6 Return to Bifocal Reading of Never Let Me Go

- Push is to read novel as about othering and otherness and how bildung is thwarted for those not given secure path to future and it is about that but not just that
- Novel is also about bildung in general and people in general
  - Ishiguro has created characters who are fully human and like the normals, identical genetically
  - Characters are by enlarge white as far as we can tell (not racially othered)
  - But characters deprived of full humanity
    - Lack typical biological parents
    - Lack future
    - Lives are not their own and don't belong to others which gives most humans sense of identity
  - In this way (particularized reading) characters represent anyone deprived of full freedom and personhood
  - Characters any group that society relegates to serving others
  - Ishiguro wants to say that art can counter that stigmatization
    - Not the art that the students make (not agreeing that students must prove humanity through art)
    - Ishiguro's novel as a work of art has ability to convince us of character's personhood
    - In the process Ishiguro has used narration and conventions of Bildungsroman to overcome characters' otherness
    - Because he does it so successfully we can have bifocal reading → characters don't represent just otherness or just us
  - Final scene where Tommy and Kathy confront Miss Emily captures bifocal
    - scene where Tommy and Kathy encounter otherness more so than they ever have
    - we could have gotten background at the beginning but it would have interfered with our ability to see them as fully human and like us

        - we see Tommy and Kathy encounter vision of themselves as not fully human (repetition of when they saw themselves as spiders in madam's eyes)
        - similarities between guardians and themselves in this instance
            - Miss Emily is in a wheelchair just as Tommy is recently in wheelchair
            - Why is there all this detail about this cabinet? → like Kathy she is attached to object from her past, an object that must have memories and holds things and she is concerned about letting go of it
- Tommy telling kathy he will get different carer and she should just shift to being donor, current too strong and they have to let go, shame because they've loved each other all their lives but can't stay together forever → Bifocal
    - about them being clones, but could also be speech of anyone with spouse having terminal illness and the other person will also die someday but not yet
    - once you know you will die you're in a separate world even though it's the same thing everyone will have → no one who won't die
    - being about them being clones but also being about them being humans
    - particularized reading → we deny what we have in common with these characters, we other them again, mobius strip of this novel, when we deny what we have in common with them we are also doing what they do → living in denial about death
    - kathy in denial, ruth in fantasy, tommy all over the place → has strong emotional reactions which is what disturbs everyone but also tries to do art to make it ok later
- Universal reading → clones are not people we should feel bad for and try and help but that they're us - we also have less agency than we think they do
    - kids in school dream they will become celebrities and they don't
    - lives dominated by acquiring little things → universal allegory for capitalism

    - invested in denial and false hope - also extremely universal, most people spend most of their lives avoiding unpleasant truths like death and for good reason impossible to live thinking constantly about death

[Book 6] 6.7 Storytelling

- How to maintain commitment to bildung? and growth and development? knowing that loss is inevitable and existence is ephemeral → similar in that way to Sula
- Ishiguro's answer is storytelling, for better and for worse
- Storytelling connects us to what we have lost, to live is to lose life and things and connections and relationships, storytelling keeps you connected to everything you've lost
- Story is connected to repair and damage in their relationships (Kathy and Ruth and Kathy and Tommy and Ruth and Tommy) and also their bodies
- Storytelling at least in words can repair damage and damaged relationships
- Storytelling can help us imagine future we may never inhabit (think about Kathy telling man about Hailsham at the beginning)
- Storytelling can create something that lasts after we are gone
- Storytelling as zig zagging delay of ephemeral
- Ishiguro suggests that refusal to fully accept reality and creative ability is what makes us human
- A lot of what we have read is about Bildung being about accepting reality, conventional of bildung
    - Francis in Conversations with Friends
    - Eugene in Pere Goriot
- Ishiguro is saying let us have our stories and denial
- Our relationship to narrator
    - Novels where people have criticism of narrator

        - Kathy → why does she not acknowledge, why does she keep letting things go on

Book 5: Sula

[Book 5] 5.1 Toni Morrison (1931-2019)

- Essayist and critic as well as novelist
- Morrison majored in English
- Won Nobel prize in literature
- Worked in publishing
- Bluest Eye (1970) published when she was 39
- She wrote many novels - Song of Solomon, Beloved, Bluest Eye, Jazz, Paradise
- Sula is now one of her least read and least taught books, used to be taught more
- One of her best, poetic, revolutionary

[Book 5] 5.2 Why are we reading Sula?

- Not typical Bildungsroman
- Existential Bildungsroman
    - Takes question what does it mean to grow up and reframes it in terms of meaning of life itself
    - Existentialist BR doesn't focus on material success or emotional growth or spiritual redemption
    - Existentialist BR asks how do we live freely in the face of loss, suffering, and death?
- Shadrag's national suicide day - existentialist
    - he institutes it to:
        - order and focus experience

        - sort out his fear of death and dying
- What Shadrag is doing with national suicide day Morrison is doing with whole novel
- Sula also explores individuality → interested in deficiencies and excesses of individualism
- Why is it called Sula?
    - Sula as a character is hyper individualist
    - Novel stresses importance of collective
    - What is it like to live like that → as a hyper individualist

[Book 5] 5.3 Opening Paragraph

- Proper nouns come very late and none of them refer to characters
- Opening foregrounds deindividuation (different from Baldwin because no individuals here)
- No name zone
- Opening of go tell it on the mountain was what will john become what will he be → here there is emphasis on group conflict and destruction
    - “they” are destroying something that Black people created
- Emphasis on loss, not on potential, emphasis on what used to be
- Loss spans many tenses
    - “there will be” “they are going to” “there was”
- Raises question of what exactly has been lost → a neighborhood (not a town)
    - town would be official and abstract
    - neighborhood is about people, neighbors, through physical proximity have established social relationship
    - exists not as physical or political entity but in actions of people and in their shared consciousness

    - for that to be destroyed means that the actions of people and shared consciousness are gone
    - neighborhood is more ephemeral and vulnerable to destruction than a place
        - ends when people move or bonds dissolve
    - neighborhood can be preserved and memorialized in writing
    - this narrator doesn't begin in characters minds - cinematic panning of power of narration
- Deindividuation in this passage
    - paragraph begins with collective nouns and pronouns - everything is plural
        - "they" doing the uprooting
        - Black people who live there
        - children who sat down in pear trees
    - deindividuation is not a problem in this context (with Baldwin it was) → might actually be a boon, might relieve people of burden of being isolated individual
    - move from conventional way of thinking about people to sub-individualism (body parts) unit smaller than individual
    - we tend to think of bodily fragments as a result of mutilation and violent
    - phrase "time and a half" associated with strenuous work → exhaustion, limits of body
    - but phrase is being repurposed - celebration of extended leisure
    - sentence has fall and elongation in it, relaxing
- Opening tells us that this book is about selfhood without individuality
- Sup, supra, higher
    - sub individual is below level of individual, like fragments and body parts
    - supra individual is collective made up of multiple individuals who blur together (Deweys)

    - hyper individuality - more of an attitude or stance, individual who insists above all else on their desires and their personality, doesn't care about ties or obligations to others
        - destroys ties to friends, lovers, etc
        - destroys bonds that normally seen as supporting an individual

[Book 5] 5.4 Magical Realism

- Author most associated with magical realism is Gabriel Garcia Marquez
- Magical realism creates world grounded in ordinary space and time
    - we recognize dates, historical events, laws of gravity, no one is turning into bugs
    - reason its not just realism is that Morrison introduces fanciful and marvelous details
        - surrealism → unreal situation punctuated with realist details
        - magical realism → real situation and fanciful details
- Reasons Sula is magical realism
    - One reason Sula is magical realism is that opening evokes fairytale → there was once a neighborhood - once upon a time
    - Release of butterflies into Sula's room → image of magical realism
    - pg 14 Shadrag falls into sleep of new life - "sleep deeper than hospital drugs"
    - 1923 chapter - begins out of order, personification of windows and trees
- Magical realism infuses the everyday with the sense of the mythic and the epic
    - Sula is compact novel
    - Entirely in one small neighborhood
    - Grand cosmic feel of the book
        - Characters names

        - Examples
            - BoyBoy - symbolic of what character is supposed to be, infantilizing
            - Ajax, Helen - names from history
            - Shadrag - biblical name, figure who walks unharmed through fiery furnace
            - Peace - sense of something global and abstract, homonym for “piece”
            - Chicken Little - from mother goose rhymes
            - Eva is variant of Eve - bible
            - Jude is variant of Judas
        - Names typically embody individualism
        - These names do more than that - some of them are depersonalizing, also connect people to other places and times, connect novel to other registers of literature
        - Names make characters seem ordinary and unordinary
        - Onomastics - study of names (we just engaged in this)
        - Names give character sense of having multiple temporal layers
            - Genesis, trojan war, crucifixion
- Magical realism tends to be whimsical, never stretches credulity the way surrealism does

[Book 5] 5.5 Form of Novel and Narrator

- Narrator
    - Mobility in time and storytelling
    - Diegesis/Exegesis
        - Diegesis - order of events in story world
        - Exegesis - order of events as we are told

    - When exegesis and diegesis don’t match shows narrator’s presence
    - Narrator is telling us that they are not rooted or limited to any particular character
    - Narrator does not put characters in hierarchy
    - Novel’s form is very elliptical
        - what happens to years in between → no clue
    - Narrator flaunts supra-individual
        - not tethered to ordinary time and space
        - not going to iron it out and put time in hierarchy of before and after
        - flaunting freedom
- As reading think about existential question - how do you live with loss, pain, loneliness and thrive in the face of them?
- If you get happily ever after not hard to live with it
    - LEVIN in anna karenina
- Recap
    - Morrison writing novel where units of being are larger and smaller than character
    - Mode of the book is magical realism
    - Elliptical nature of the book - no causal explanation, jumps around, etc

[Book 5] 5.6 Mirrors

- Developing coherent self image is central to bildung
    - inside and outside match
    - perceptions of self and others of self match
    - clear sense of what it means to be you and not anybody else
- Shadrack opening
    - returns to Medallion blasted and ravaged

    - novel opens with chaos of war
    - unwriting of first page - body keeps running head shot off
    - Shadrack's has lost all sense of self "he didn't even know who or what he was"
- Shadrack mirror scene
    - Morrison presenting Blackness as wholeness
    - unwriting history of Blackness as absence or alienation
    - rewriting of WEB DuBois' double consciousness
    - Shadrack experiencing his Blackness as definite and unequivocal, confirms his realness and existence - no external factor just him
    - "he wanted nothing more" → absolute fullness
    - desire to see own face → sense of possession, its his own desire
    - unable to see himself at first, he needs to increase darkness to see his face
    - "grave black face" → death and life coming together
    - "black so definite so unequivocal it astonished him"
    - in moment when things cant get anything worse that Shadrack makes something different
    - Shadrack creates ritual to contain suddenness and precarity of life by putting it in one day
    - people of the Bottom make space for Shadrack
    - that is his Bildung
        - not job or marriage or anything else like that
        - not normative progress
    - ritual is cyclical
    - Shadrack's achievement of cyclical stasis is triumphant
- Nel's journey with mother

    - Nel introduced in second chapter - journey from North to South
    - what does this journey mean for parent - child relationship
    - Nel sees mother's authority challenged for the first time and sees dignity undone by lack of toilet
    - Racist social order is undoing family order and therefore messing with Nel's sense of self
    - "if she were really custard there was a chance Nel was too"
- Return home
    - Helene's response is to clean and put things back in order
    - Nel is more stirred up - exhilarating trip but a fearful one
- Nel's mirror scene
    - Nel has seen Helene lose her boundaries she tries to reassert herself
    - un-names herself - I'm me
    - reclaims from parents
- Sula mirror scene
    - feeling possession
    - looking in mirror wondering if she is good looking
    - looks in mirror in response to Ajax
    - final step - becomes somewhat domesticated, cleaned and cooked, table set, bed made
    - when he leaves sula becomes fixated on Ajax's absence
    - ribbon in scene is symbol of containment, green symbol of jealousy
    - sula is tying hair with ribbon, containing hair
    - hair for African American women about navigating free and containment
    - few pages later Sula fixates on Ajax's drivers license - his identity
    - by looking in mirror she lost her senes of self

    - sign of danger of looking in mirror - trying to decide if she was good looking or not, up until this point she didn't care, now she has fallen into concern with others
    - chapter ends with Sula saying she sung all the songs she's sung and in the next chapter she dies - looking in the mirror killed her
- What dies when sula dies? What does sula represent? Book is called sula...
    - like with Pere Goriot titular character does not survive novel
    - means sula is important and significant but not liveable
    - what kind of self did sula have before she looked in the mirror?
- Put sula in situation from other book and see what she would do - Maria, Darnforth's story
    - sarcasm - wouldn't let him finish whole story
- One word to define sula
    - unbothered
    - observer

[Book 5] 5.7 Sula's Hyper-individualism

- Sula returns to true self in death
    - pg 148 - dying she finds herself completely alone where she had always wanted to be
    - desire to be completely alone
    - does not subordinate herself ever to connections with family friends or community
    - deepest desires and most active quest involve connection with self
    - "post coital privateness in which she met herself welcomed herself and joined herself in harmony" → wants sex because of self connection
    - before she looked in mirror everything was a mirror
    - everything was something she could see herself in

- Sula is queer
  - she refuses conventional heterosexual femininity which involves thinking about others instead of oneself
  - insists that she is not going to be supportive of men or nurture children
  - until mirror scene does not derive self worth from being attractive and does not focus on others' pleasure more than her own
  - pg 142 - disagreement with Nel about having it all
    - woman + person of color = absolute freedom people imagine men have
    - "ain't that the same as being a man" → Sojourner Truth reference "ain't I a woman" - can't define femininity in terms of weakness if you define it in terms of black women
  - queerness is not about gender its about her refusal of custard like individuality that defines heteronormative femininity
  - pg 143 - Nel asks what she has to show for it
    - Sula says she has her mind, her loneliness is hers unlike Nels
    - "they ain't worth more than me" → not men aren't more than women, not collective vs collective, collective just against herself
    - her standard of value is herself and herself alone
    - that is what makes her hyper-individualist
- Morrison doesn't want us to judge Sula but see her as rare experience in living, not sustainable but in a novel to look at what happens when character does that challenges our ideas of how people have to live
- Not just something that happens when sula is dying
- 1937 chapter Sula's return to Bottom
  - has a fight with Eva very similar to fight with Nel
  - Eva asks when she will have babies → "I dont want to make somebody else I want to make myself"

    - Sula challenges whether Eva has done the things she's asking Sula to do
    - Eva thinks its animalistic to be that individualist → calls her a roach
        - roaches are ugly
        - roaches are uncanny
        - roaches are very hardy
- Sula is hyper-individualist, queer, and in many ways like a prototypical adolescent - fluid, volatile, mercurial
    - pg 53 cant be counted on to sustain emotion for very long
    - hyper individualist but cant sustain single self for long
    - pg 121 - narrator calls sula an artist without an art form - lacks containment
    - final way to see sula's volatility is birthmark
        - birthmark typically seen as distinctive sign that marks someone
        - defines her as someone always changing because the birthmark is always changing
- Sula is also amoral
    - so many of African American responses to racism have been to be about most respectable and virtuous
    - what if someone decided to not believe in good or evil
    - Sula is Nietzschen character - beyond good and evil
    - Nietzsche questions value of morals - real value of moral values is to say that people with most power are good - much of what people call good is glorification of those with most power
    - Sula claims this power - what is good is me
    - Sula just wants to claim ownership in herself and deny that anyone else has claim on her
    - community reacts to Sula as though she was trying to dominate others - if she is not doing the job of supporting others then she is hurting them
    - Morrison wants us to see Sula as beyond good and evil

- Vision sula has on deathbed of everyone loving her eventually shows dissolving of boundaries
    - reminds me of Lila - dissolving boundaries and ignoring other boundaries
- Bildung about unlearning harmful norms → sula never internalized harmful norms to begin with
    - Ajax comments that she is fully her own
- Sula's amorality secures self possession
- Pick up with "how do you know you're the good one"

[Book 5] 5.8 Existential Bildung + How Do You Know You Were the Good One?

- Sula as child is more like regular individual
- Hyper individuality is when she comes back
- Sula hears mother say she loves her but doesn't like her and narrator says Sula learned that "there's no other you can count on"
- Sula watches mother burn and what narrator emphasizes is distance and detachment
    - Sula describes it as aesthetic experience not emotional or ethical
    - Nel associates Sula with aesthetic
    - "I didn't mean anything. I never meant anything" → on one hand she produces emphatic assertions of selfhood, at the same time produces radical negations of selfhood
        - Narrator remarks on 119 that Sula has no ego, because she has no ego doesn't need other people to support it, can unmoor herself from community
        - I didn't mean anything captures this
        - First meaning - no intentions here, was not trying to kill her mother
        - Second meaning - "I" also has no meaning, assertion of fundamental lack of self which enables radical freedom

- Killing of chicken little - pivotal event of novel
  - Narrator tells us that act of killing chicken little teaches sula that there is no self to count on
  - Depicted as gratuitous act
  - Andre Gide, Lafcadio's Adventures - character is on a train and just tosses someone off it
  - "Slip"
  - Nel has to confront for the first time what she felt after killing chicken little - the good feeling she had, why did it feel good?
  - Is Nel really the good one? → is it truly good to expect something in return for being good
  - When Sula dies Nel and community have to confront that what they project onto Sula - evil - is what they have inside
- Existentialism - how do you find meaning in life despite inevitability of pain and loss and suffering
- Ending of the book is the book's vision of existential bildung
  - Sula overturns foundation of convention Bildungsroman - overturns idea of foundations themselves, no solid grown
  - Novel repeatedly returns to idea of characters stripped of what gives self in conventional bildungsroman - no private property, money, social status, family and marriage are unstable
  - Lesson from this model (Bildungsroman imparts lessons) - true art of life is not about achieving conventional attributes of selfhood which are never secure
  - True art of selfhood is learning to live and thrive without conventional things in self hood
    - Not that you have to shed them the way sula does
    - But Sula is character most equipped to deal with death

    - Sula not grim novel - leans into loss, imagines people doing more than surviving loss
    - What would it mean to thrive in loss? to thrive in pain and suffering and the awareness of death?
    - How do you sustain yourself in a world that doesn't sustain you?
    - If you think of loss pain loneliness and sadness as something to avoid in order to grow, you have hard time growing because they are not inevitable?
- Last sentence - description of cry of pain and description of life if you let go of idea of triumphing over pain

Book 4: Go Tell it on the Mountain

- Represents Bildungsroman in truest form (same time as Catcher in the Rye and The Bell Jar)
- Starts with character on 14th birthday, follows him on day that is momentous
- Novel organized around suspense of classic question - will protagonist become their own individual? what will that look like what will that mean? → not a classic answer
- Baldwin wants us to question whether it is even a good thing for John to have his own life?
- Think about how this novel refuses the individuation plot that's built into Bildungsroman - 4 ways it does that
    - commitment to communal bildung - individual not separate from others, individuals owe duty to others to be best selves
    - focuses on deindividuation effects of racism
    - focus on deindividuation effects of spiritualism - redemption
- Multi-focus narrative structure - in minds of John, mother, Gabriel, Florence
- Bildungsroman is clearly about John's development but we learn more about elders than him

- As though Jane Eyre had entire chapters devoted to Jane's parents and aunt from their point of view

[Book 4] 4.1 Novel's Opening + Structure

- Opening word is "everyone"
  - in the logic of sentence sequencing, "everyone" comes before "john"
  - "everyone" is defining and framing John
  - "everyone" as a word is totalizing, no sense of exceptions
  - "everyone" is a word that seems individualizing (word "one" is in it) takes "one" and attaches it to collective, general entity
  - "always" is also there to add on
  - what this everyone wants is a repetition → just like his father, doubling down on repetition
  - everyone wants to make sure future John reproduces the past by doing what his father does
  - Second sentence effectively says the same thing showing efficacy of saying this → everyone saying it has made John believe it
    - belief implies faith not reason
    - john has taken it on faith that he will dedicate life to father's faith
  - novel makes very clear very quickly that everyone is not literal
  - everyone is referring to very specific community - church
  - church functions as blocking out everything outside, make people feel like church is everyone and everything ⇒ just like the word everyone blocks out the rest, blocks out sinners, movies
  - turning church into everyone blocks out earthly world of present which is dominated by racist white supremacy
  - sentence assets force of everyone against john's own self
- Structure

- begins week before birthday
- starts by talking about what typical sunday is like - communalization of time
- then it becomes sunday before his birthday
- only on page 10 do we start on his birthday
- novel goes out of its way goes out of way to not start at home and in family - church is just as important
- first story we get is story of his aunt (not father or mother)
- what is significance of looking at parents stories and why do we start with Florence?

[Book 4] 4.2 James Baldwin (1924-1987)

- Raised in Harlem oldest of 9 children born in 1924
- Many aspects of Go Tell it on the Mountain are autobiographical
- Father was not his biological father but called him that, father was preacher
- Moved to Greenwich Village, somewhat racially integrated
- 1948 moved to Paris and other parts of europe - where he began to devote himself to writing
- Found that it was easier to be African American in europe than in US
- In 1960s began returning regularly to participate in civil rights
- Died in France in 1987
- He wrote in many genres - novels, plays, essays
- One of his mentors was Richard Wright (who he also wrote criticism of his work)
- Widely read and critically acclaimed
- Open about having relationships with men, wrote about homophobia and racism

- Giovanni's Room - broke new ground in gay community, about bisexuality, had to be published first in UK

[Book 4] 4.3 Recap of Prior Lecture

- Bildungsroman focused on individualization - individual characters becoming more clearly defined, more individual
- This novel questions that in 2 ways
  - Is individuation possible for everyone?
  - Is it desirable?
- Novel starts by deindividuation time and space
  - Starting in his room would be individual
  - Starting is just sunday morning but not clear when
  - Opens up in communal space not private space
  - Opens with memories of sundays in general
  - Distinguishing aspect of sunday is that family is united collective "they all rose together on that day" → rare
  - "Every sunday morning"

[Book 4] 4.4 Multi Focal Narrative

- Unusual move for bildungsroman to have multi focal narrative
- Often blur out parents to highlight emergent adulthood (catcher in the rye)
- This story lets elders pull away from John's story
- Most of pages devoted to aunt, stepfather, mother
- Conveys that this story is John's story but John's story is not John's alone
- Section that focuses on him in part 1 ends with Florence, mother, and father coming in to church
- His solo moment ends with elders coming in to his story
- Temporality of the story is not linear

- Novel is braiding past and present together so the difference collapses
- Multi generation novel often about world changing a lot, about difference
- This is a multigenerational novel about sameness - emphasized by fact that we can't even keep track of where we are when reading the novel
- Structure that puts elder's story in the middle tells us that they are the center of the story
- The child's story is the parent's story
- Structural force of racism affects all of them in the same way → racism getting reproduced from one era to the next
    - Gabriel witnesses lynchings
    - Florence scared of being raped by white supremacists
    - Richard's arrest
    - Distinction between life in and out of slavery not as distinct as would be expected
- Racism affecting children and adults both, corroding differences between parent and child
    - Parents supposed to be stronger than children and better at taking care of them
    - But in the face of arbitrary and permitted violence, parents are just as helpless
    - Sense that moving from childhood to adulthood is being thwarted
- Religious world is alternative to worldly world that is refusing to change
- pg 31 talking about white people "not today nor tomorrow neither"
    - individual development hindered by racism and time doesn't matter it won't change
    - "this world was not for him" "never let him enter"
- Structural repression thwarts bildung

- structural repression is dehumanizing - by definition frustrates development of best aspects of human
- structural repression thwarts bildung by homogenizing people in the group
  - Richard interaction with police and storeowner → says you're all the same
- bildung based on progressive change, structural repression repeats itself
- by constantly threatening arbitrary violence, structural repression prevents targets from plotting their course

[Book 4] 4.5 Florence

- Can be seen as double for John
- Both hate Gabriel
- Both ambivalent to church and end up there
- Not a very optimistic double - Florence is dying and her story is all about the difficulty of achieving change
- At the very start of novel she notes how constant her brother's hate is - constancy is true of Florence as well
- Her story is about trying to change only to find yourself back where you started
- Her life had led her back to mother's starting place - altar of the lord
- As young woman her vision was to walk out and never return
- Repetition of her mother's emancipation story
- In both cases desire to walk out and never return, emancipatory break
- Florence's story might foreshadow John's failure to do something different
- Moment when Florence buys ticket to NY to escape family's sexism and south's racism
  - Great Migration - based on hope of radically different and better life in the north

    - Florence is trying to enter stream of history, attempt to participate in progress
- Frank represents someone whose life is antithesis of Bildung
    - “it was he who unforgivably taught her that coming along is a perpetual process, people who are destined never to alive, for ten years he had come along but when he left her he was the same man she married”
    - understand frustration that Florence feels
    - but also if racism will keep him from moving what’s the point in trying to progress
    - similarities to Esther who insists she doesn’t want to grow or change - determined not to want what she can’t find with ease
    - refusing bildung brings them happiness - found space within world where by not trying to change and getting frustrated they can achieve worldly grace

[Book 4] 4.6 Baldwin’s Aesthetics - Naturalism

- Modernist (a bit not as much as others)
- Naturalism (biological determinism)
    - late 19th century movement started in France by Emile Zola (Rougon-Macquart series) heavily influenced by Darwinism
    - Darwin was interpreted as seeing destiny in biology
    - Future embedded in past
    - Overwhelming force is inheritance, biology
        - addiction, mental and physical illness, personality type etc
    - Sense that children can’t be too different from parents
- Baldwin doesn’t necessarily believe in that
- Naturalism (social determinism) - social forces around you (like industrialization) would affect your life in ways you cannot control

    - Makes it hard to write novel because novel is about taking action and doing stuff
- Naturalism novel - forces against character and nothing they do will be able to overcome those forces
- Shape of plot in naturalist novel -
    - Typical naturalist novel is very interested in downward slide into poverty, sexual obsession, alcoholism
    - Characters seen as succumbing to gravity (literally falling and slipping or unable to resist appetite)
- Zola - L'Assommoir 1877 - kiss in laundry room first step in slow downfall together
- Accidents play big role in determining character's outcomes
- Foregrounding of accidents highlight difficulty of having agency over your life

[Book 4] 4.7 Go Tell it on the Mountain Engagement with Naturalism

- Elizabeth going north with Richard without being married was first in sordid series of mistake that would cause her to fall so low
- Go Tell it on the Mountain preoccupied with descent
- When Elizabeth meets Florence they bond over being "fallen women"
- Many characters literally fall on the ground a lot
- Naturalism obsessed with dirt and we see it in the novel
    - Family's last name is Grimes
    - Description of apartment and John cleaning it shows how dirt is so ingrained in apartment
    - Equation between name Grimes and grimy apartment shows that they are their surroundings
- Baldwin interested in juxtaposing literal meanings of falling and dirt with symbolic and spiritual meaning

- Fall into to poverty (literal), fall into sin (symbolic and spiritual)
- Dirt of physical grime (physical), filth of spiritual wrongdoing (spiritual and symbolic) → Gabriel has a lot to say about this
- Dust juxtaposition at beginning and end of novel
    - in first part of novel John sweeps actual dust twice, first from carpets in house and then from floor of church
    - in last part of novel John finds himself lying on church floor (fallen) with dust in his nostrils, this dust represents the dust from which god made Adam, forming a new being is exactly what Bildung is supposed to do

[Book 4] 4.8 Spiritualism + Naturalism

- Unique aspect of novel is combination of naturalism and spiritualism
- Go Tell it on the Mountain mixes dirt and falling with Christian notions of fall into sin (not just fall into poverty)
- Usually naturalism novel is anti religious
- Free indirect discourse - narrator's voice mingles with voice of character
- John sweeping actual dust both in home and in church, final part he's lying on church floor dust in his nostrils this dust is the dust from which god formed Adam, dust from which things can be born again anew
- What is the effect of putting these two things together?
- One way to think about the combination is as antagonistic, opposites, spirituality comes into solve problem of naturalism
    - Why would you bring religion into naturalist novel? → because only religion can counter forces of structural oppression
    - Naturalist streak of the novel shows how racism annihilates individuality and keeps people from growing, impedes growth
    - Church counters this with a positive version of the annihilation of individuality
    - We are used to individuality prevailing (capitalist notion)

- In social form of racism people made one by being equally subject to racism (difference between generations disappears because people keep getting oppressesed)
- In the church, church goers are made one by worship, in god, ecstatic version of deindividuation
  - Instead of being reduced to things naturalism foregrounds, in the church loss of individuality expands them as members of the whole
  - Surrendering individuality and agency in prayer not to force that attacks them but to transcendent power of spirit inside or to the lord
- Christianity lays people low on physical plane in order to raise them high in spiritual plane
  - When Florence cries in church “let him bring you low so he can raise you up” this is the antithesis of naturalism which brings you low to law you low
  - Florence says its futile to try to walk upright, falls on her face in the alter (laid low physically)
- She experiences herself “hurled outward into time where no boundaries were” pg 86
  - loss of sense of beginning middle end
  - not despairing sense, more liberating
  - in eternity god doesn’t work the same way → positive counterpart to timeless racism which books structure reinforces
- God - omnipotent, unchanging, all good

- Another way to think about it is book combines naturalism and spiritualism, antagonism leads to them being synthesized because Baldwin is trying to take the naturalism and give it a christian form
  - passage about broadway takes on tone of sermon and bible pg 28
    - takes on something naturalistic and turns it into sermon
    - broadway becomes a parable

        - “narrow” refers not to physical but to difficulty of entering heaven
        - inverted sentences
        - elevated diction and intricate syntax
            - word choice is elevated (”thereon”, “ignoble”)
            - poetic cast
            - 6 line sentence with multiple clauses - gives a sense of build up and containing complexity in something intricate
        - repeating same word at beginning of sentence or clause “but…”
            - typically more repetition in spoken than written
            - also hallmark of rhetoric speech often find more repetition
    - naturalism is about the body and the material and physical world, pessimistic
    - christianity about soul not body and is profoundly optimistic, greatest sinner has the most capacity to find redemption in faith (story of prodigal son)
    - lord is a metaphor for the force that will only let you fall so low (in naturalism there is no floor)
        - Esther is told lord will not let her fall so low, Gabriel tells her if she calls on the lord he will lift her up
    - Baldwin is torn between naturalist accounts and christian ones (not fully invested in either when writing this book)
    - Why are these people religious?
        - Escape from ordinary life, escape from structural oppression
        - Church is place for Black people where they can have ambition and desire for power
            - See it most with Gabriel’s desire for authority, status, and power in becoming a preacher
- Being saved is form of bildung - acquiring more perfect form

- Naturalist/secular reading of being saved is that it frees him from father's oppression
- Being saved hinders bildung in that he ends up as preacher like father, but cannot vanquish fear of father without being saved and becoming equal of his father

[Book 4] 4.9 Spiritual Bildung Overcoming Naturalism

- Key question of novel as Bildungsroman is how is john going to have life outside of his father and father's father?
- How does final section undo conflict with John being own person and like father?
- How does experience of being born again take up naturalist elements of novel and give them new meaning and value
  - Deindividuation
  - Falling
    - John falls on filthy ground, dust in his nostrils, like a bird fallen from height, dead man's body (rock → corpse → dying bird, moving towards more animate)
    - Initially feels himself falling even deeper below the floor
    - Screaming but not speaking words until he hears "jesus saves"
  - Dirt
  - Cyclical temporality undoing difference between generations
- Naturalism also gets born again and all its elements get turned into something spiritual
- Is John going to become his own person is the wrong question
- The only way for him to have his own life is to have a life that incorporates others - ancestors, family, and god
- That is what gives him life but it will never be just his own
- God unites all (I, we, he, them)

- Spiritual bildung overcomes naturalism → going through, ongoing movement towards god
- Ending - I'm ready, I'm coming, I'm on my way
    - something real
    - represents coming through/going through that he experienced on threshing floor

Book 3: The Metamorphosis

- The Metamorphosis (1915) unusual to include in Bildungsroman - categorized as Anti-Bildungsroman
- Limit cases of a genre reveal something that a classic work would not (not following rules tells us about genre)
- Bildungsroman asks what it means to mature as a human being, embedded assumption is distinction as human species → metamorphosis depicts human turning into animal
- It gets us to question the boundary between human and animal, reversal gets us to think in fundamental and questioning way about the premise of the Bildungsroman that we've taken for granted - the human
- Effective work for transitioning into contemporary fiction where the sense of the world and people is different
- The Metamorphosis engage an aspect of coming of age that is important for future Bildungsroman - transition from childhood to adulthood that we call adolescence

[Book 3] 3.1 Adolescence Overview

- Jane Eyre skips over adolescence - child at 10 and then adult at 18 when she's earning her own living and directly child's education
    - Brontë's reasoning is that nothing really happened in that period - narrative ellipsis

    - Another reason that this period is skipped is that people in 1847 did not see adolescence as distinct stage
- There have always been people between 12 and 18 but concept of adolescence emerges in 1904
- How do we define adolescence?
    - age between childhood and adulthood
    - frustration with lack of autonomy, desiring of independence, impulsivity
    - rebelliousness
    - emotional growth
    - different type of relationships to friends/peers than childhood → more like adult relationships
    - self awareness
    - ideas about who you want to be
    - sense of identity
    - confusion
    - awkward
    - puberty
- Before concept of adolescence emerged
    - Ancient Greece, Europe around 1890s, term people used for period between childhood and adulthood was youth
    - Youth meant not an adult but also connotes being older than a child, marked by onset of puberty, associated with sexual development and rebellious rowdy behavior
    - Youth was not seen so much as a distinct stage like adolescence, more like adulthood-lite
    - Youths worked and did whatever adult family members did
    - People as young as 14 and 15 did marry
- Adolescence started emerging in US and europe around 1870s

    - Reasons - rise of consumer culture - segmented audiences, and also rise of education
    - by 1870s not considered appropriate to marry before 17 or 18
    - by 1870s fashions for people in their teens very different from fashions for people in their 20s
    - 1850s in England, France, and US public education starts to become available and compulsory
    - it becomes compulsory that people stay in school for longer
    - definition of adulthood shifts to when education is completed (new definition of adulthood)
    - in time of metamorphosis that is roughly age 16-18
- Adolescence: Its Psychology and its Relations to Physiology, Anthropology, Sociology, Sex, Crime, Religion, and Education (1904) by G Stanley Hall
    - Totalizing concept, adolescence meant to be connected to every aspect of a person
    - Very modern concept, many of items in subtitle list are modern ish words around 1904 (physiology and anthropology very new)
    - Hall believed every adolescent experienced some form of religious conversion
    - Distinguishing things about adolescence
        - Constant change and growth
        - Time of plasticity and spontaneity
        - Exploration and testing limits
        - Contradictory state - intense vitality but also painful, open and imaginative but also most shy and awkward and insecure, power (vitality) and powerlessness, strength and peak period of sexuality but also lazy and aimless
    - Summary in one word: liminal stage
        - liminal means transitional, occupying both sides of a boundary

    - Adolescents are performers - rely on imitation, dramatic, thought that adolescents had strong speech consciousness
        - either speak a lot or they become very shy and hesistant to speak
- Adolescence liminal because it hovers between adulthood and childhood, has some qualities from each
    - adolescents both inside and outside the family
    - inside and outside the established order
    - dependent and independent
    - hyperactive and unusually passive
    - between innocence and experience
    - emotional volatility - swinging between moods
    - liminal space between identities - trying new things out
- Adolescence is more gendered than childhood because of association with sex
    - Adolescent boys - need to become more bold, strong, decisive, competitive
    - Adolescent girls - mature by becoming selfless, not as active, control impulses and appetites, to nurture and care for others, learn to be pleasing and attractive, not taking up too much space
    - Time when people experiment with gender and sexuality

[Book 3] 3.2 Adolescence in Bildungsroman

- Adolescence in 20th century - reservoir of different and originality and potential change
- Adults = past and adolescence = future
- Teenagers expected to conform but also usher in something new
- If adolescence is seen as inevitably bringing change and progress then that means there is a new horror of going backwards and of stasis

- Adolescence is about border crossing which can be scary and horrifying, anxiety → Im not good enough
- Gregor Samsa is not adolescent - older than that, and he has been functioning as older than he is because taking on adult obligations which has prevented him from achieving full adulthood (no wife and children of his own)
- Gregor is on liminal state between adulthood and childhood
  - old enough to have completed military service but mother calls him a boy
  - terrified of father
  - something like an adolescent
  - depicted between hovering between human and insect - when story opens consciousness is human but body is insect
- Kafka as an author - way of approaching fiction that is very distinctive
  - Kafkaesque situation:
    - surreal (not unreal) - colloquially means dreamlike but it is more accurate to say surreal juxtaposes unreal and hyperreal
      - unreal - has become an insect
      - hyperreal - room looks like proper human room
      - mundane details coexist with extraordinary things → surreal
      - like to dreamlike states is that it happens in dreams like that - concrete details and also unreal things
    - saturated with bad painful feelings - guilt, dread, fear of punishment
      - debt that Gregor's family owes the boss
      - debt and guild and blame creates atmosphere of persecution and paranoia
    - mysterious because they are under-explained
      - Gregor transformed into giant bug and no clue how or why, very underexplained

        - The Trial (Kafka) - protagonist is arrested but no one tells him crime, knows he has to be at court but not told where or when
        - to be in Kafkaesque situation is to feel completely in the wrong and unable to do anything about it
            - very little agency a lot of guilt and anxiety
- Point is not that Gregor is an adolescent or turns into one but Metamorphosis allows us to **read adolescence as Kafkaesque state**

[Book 3] 3.3 Adolescence as Quintessentially Kafkaesque State

- Adolescence is time of dramatic transformation (includes physical changes)
    - "What in the world has happened to me" pg 12
    - He doesn't just become a bug → becomes giant bug, now experiences himself as out of proportion
        - Can't move through his door the same way, much wider pg 27 → growth spurt
    - New capacity to intimidate people, inspired more fear than human Gregor
        - General manager arrives at apartment to hector Gregor and then hears his animal voice and gets scared, when he sees him he backs away
        - Fathers expressions of submissions, cries pg 42, powerful figure reduced to tears by sight of newly large son
            - Trope of adolescent boyhood who suddenly becomes aware of size and strength can face down paternity/authority that abused or belittled him
    - Contradiction between what adolescents are allowed to do and what adults are
        - Momentary surge of power but he can't leverage it, he's a captive → father becomes even more tyrannical
            - Father can hiss like an animal but Gregor cannot
    - Physical changes

        - Defines insect body to human standards, feels lack of control
        - Analogy to sexuality not in anyone's control
        - Experiences new body as foreign, inadequate, unwieldy, and chaotic
    - His way of dealing with change is to try and go back to sleep → ultimate adolescent trope
    - Conflict with family over his room
    - Voice changes - unmistakably old voice but infiltrated from below, by tortured peeping sound
        - Speech consciousness
        - Newly eloquent and also newly inarticulate - each word understandable only for a second before peeing sound takes over
        - No one understands long speech and he shortly gives up on speaking to family
        - Family assumes that bc they can't understand him he can't understand them
            - Disability
        - Inarticulate and misunderstood → quintessentially adolescent
- Kafka is saying transition to adulthood doesn't always happen - can get trapped in between adolescence
- What makes Gregor's situation that of an adolescent is that he can't communicate with family and can't alter it

[Book 3] 3.4 Kafka

- Born 1883 in Prague died young of tuberculosis in 1924
- Jewish family (minority) in what was then Austro-Hungarian Empire
- 3 younger sisters all died during holocaust
- Father ran successful business, Kafka expected to take it over but he resisted

- 100 page letter to father where he explains how father's treatment prevents him from moving on with life having children etc
- Kafka always experienced himself as different, out of place, minority in the world and also in family
- Kafka admired Goethe and Flaubert as writers more than anyone else
- Whats happening to Gregor registers with adolescence but also with anyone not fitting the norm → aging (extreme age), disability of any kind

[Book 3] 3.5 What The Metamorphosis Says About Bildung

- About developing to a being of fullest expression of being human
- The Metamorphosis shows how fear of not moving forward and not growing up that makes adolescence such a terrible state
  - Fear of failure to become adult
  - Terror inflicted on those who don't adopt adult norms
- Story about how terrible it is to be treated as other
- Gregor's problem not that he turned into bug but that he's a bug trapped in human family
  - Experiences sense of agency and wellbeing as bug (when he's on the floor and on the legs) - legs obey perfectly → bug being is not all loss
  - Wounds heal remarkably quickly (early part 2) compares to human body healing previous month
  - Abilities become disabilities because he is in human world not bug world

[Book 3] 3.6 Loss of Self → Anti-Bildungsroman

- 3 parts - in each part Gregor tries to leave room and is driven back to it
- 1st part emphasizes Gregor's being equates it with rational consciousness unified by memory
  - Descartes, "I think therefore I am"
    - Proof of existence is that you are doubting it

        - Dualism
        - Mind in charge of body
    - Kafka puts Gregor's thoughts in quotation marks pg 23 makes it feel as though he's speaking to us, quotations attribute property in speech to individual person
    - Someone seems to have lost selfhood - asserting that Gregor still has being
    - Reminded that Gregor has active mind, thinks a lot about conditions under which he's been working as traveling salesman
    - Uses a lot of reasoning when trying to figure out how to move, lot of intention
    - Holding onto selfhood based in cognition and reason, rule his body through his mind
    - Keeps worrying about head above all else when he's trying not to injure himself
    - Theory of mind - constantly speculating on what other people are thinking
- 2nd part - Gregor's body, physicality
    - Opens at dusk of the day of the metamorphosis, Gregor on the floor in the dark using feelers and drawn to food → here he acts first thinks later
    - When he gets to the door realizes he's been driven by senses, "lured", by food smell (animal sense)
    - Couldn't eat without entire body becoming "gaspingly involved"
    - Moves differently in part 2 starts crawling on walls and all that, more involved in sensations than reflections
    - Realizes that food preferences have changed - no fresh food
    - Sees less clearly
    - Hear more about his nerves
    - More about movements, sensations and reactions less thoughts

- Loses sense of passage of time
- Relates to space differently (averse to high ceilings)
- Loses aversion to dirt
- Loses conventional rationality
- First pages of part 2 still mulling over hopes and drawing conclusions but then thinking becomes less distinct and thoughts turn into physical movements
- What remains of human feeling is shame and shame is about loss of human attributes (agency, will, intention, and understanding of world)
- Key verb comes at end of sentence (typical of Kafka) - scurry (animalistic) and fact that discussing motion is linked with animals
- part 2 has an arc
  - beginning → learning and enjoying new body
  - as it progresses → loses some of that, loses ability to control head
    - “carelessly lets his head bump against the door” - doesn’t care about head as much
    - then would hold his head very still because the faint sound it produced was heard and caused family to fall silent
    - this moment is telling - captures how Gregor has lost key aspects of human identity and held on to others
    - reason and agency are starting to go but consideration is still present
    - gregor can recognize that family has thoughts and feelings different from his own
  - dramatic conclusion - gregor’s father attacks him with apples, lead up is significant
    - hinges on memory
    - pg 73 mother says removing furniture shows giving up hope, keep everything the same so they can forget

        - gregor doubles down on keeping furniture, but for different reason
            - he knows he's still himself
            - he wants to keep family heirlooms and doesn't want to forget human past
                - picture of the woman - he made the frame using tools signifies his human past as tool using being
                - desk - logic reasoning work etc
- 3rd part - weakening of gregor's body, what does it take to erase someone's being?
    - begins with gregor's lack of mobility
    - glad that images of past have disappeared - letting memories go
    - lets go of desire to provide for his family and focuses on his own hunger
    - becomes inconsiderate for first time ever to family
    - loses appetite and desire to live
    - what 3rd part really emphasizes is that selfhood is social, conferred on us by others
    - shows that self cannot exist without others
    - how gregor reacts to metamorphosis depends on how others react to it
        - part 1 before opening the door he said he was eager to learn what the others would say when they finally laid eyes on him, if they recoil in horror he doesn't have to do anything but if they react calmly he has to move on
        - social death
        - narration never lets us forget that he recognizes family members and he still has a being to recognize but family won't recognize him
        - being killed before physically dying
    - even as gregor is dying and lost sense of self he still has mind → he wondered things right before he died and thought back on family with

tenderness and love

- how did family impose social death on him?
  - attribute violent intentions to him
  - make him object of fear who has to be help captive
  - treat at worst as enemy and best with tolerance
  - tolerance is what we show to something bad and wrong but we put up with it
  - refused to look at him (no mirrors)
  - eventually assume he is not himself
  - exclusion from the circle of humankind
  - sister calls him “it” → “it has to go” “let go of notion that this thing is gregor”
    - when gregor hears this, he dies
    - physical death follows social death almost immediately
    - suggests he has sustained by family acknowledging existence
  - charwoman is only character who doesn’t do mind-body dualism → doesn’t assume you need human body to have mind
    - shown when she assumes gregor is pretending to be dead when he is dead
    - char - dirt, what remains after incineration
    - she occupies similar position so she can identify with him, knows she is human even though she is dehumanized
    - also from her point of view she’s not different from other family members - cleans up after him same as rest of them

- Summarizing anti-bildung
  - as a genre bildungsroman stresses rationality, ability to understand other people
  - even anti-bildung centers those elements

- Kafka instructs us not to reduce being to reason, understanding others etc but can't help highlighting them
- bildungsroman has a problem with the body, doesn't always understand what to do with corporeality
- self that bildungsroman is interested in charting can never exist in isolation - need to understand relationship in groups etc

[Book 3] 3.7 Components of Being Illustrated by Other Characters

- Potential (sister)
- Self-interest (sister)
- Participation in social exchange - giving or receiving
- Power (father)
- Adaptation (sister)
- Performance (mother performing care of mother)
- Pride (father)

Book 2: Jane Eyre

- Bildungsroman is story about what it means to come of age so would expect to see childhood → adolescence → adulthood
- In conversations with friends mainly about Frances as 21 year old but flash backs to adolescent self and we learn a little bit about Nick's childhood (wiz kid)
- Wilhelm Meister begins with Wilhelm remembering in great detail playing with puppet theater in childhood, Wilhelm thinks it makes him destined to become great actor later
- Jane Eyre unusual for its time because it begins when protagonist is child written for adults (other include Oliver Twist but there are many other characters and he is passive and absent)

[Book 2] 2.1 General Overview of Childhood

- What defines difference between child and adolescent and adult?
  - child - cannot provide for themselves, under certain age, have not fully grown, often have trouble expressing emotions but still feel them strongly, less impulse control, naivete
  - can’t define child without comparison to adult, child is a relative being
  - these are all qualities of modern childhood which has not fully gelled when Bronte is writing this novel
  - Paula Fass - modern ideal (post 20th century) idea of childhood - sexually innocent, economically dependent, emotionally fragile, life supposed to bedominated by play, school, family nurture
    - Depends on having above average economic resources
    - Contemporary ideal, has not always existed
    - Will use Jane Eyre as historical archive about ideas on childhood
- Characters in novel aren’t sure what child is
  - 1st page - Jane excluded from family because she’s not considered a child due to lack of happy, sociable, childlike disposition
    - Jane is 10 definitely child but Mrs. Reed finds her insufficiently childlike
    - Mrs. Reed is saying to be treated like child and considered child not enough to be an actual child
    - Everyone agrees Jane is dependent, not hit puberty, does not have full self control
    - Mrs. Reed doesn’t want Jane to be Jane as she is (shy) she wants Jane to “act natural”
    - To be childlike involves being happy, liked, open, spritely, little → cuteness
- Key elements of history of childhood
  - Always been children but children have not always been seen as childlike

    - How children experience childhood depends on ideas about childhood (not just laws or biological facts), closely linked to ideas about parenting and education
    - Childhood is a privileged state, idea of child as someone innocence, protected, cute, etc. only been enjoyed by privileged class
    - What is new is that everyone **should** get to have this kind of childhood
    - Jane is not privileged and therefore does not really get to have childhood
- A lot of ideas about childhood show up in Jane Eyre
- Raymond Williams - British cultural critic who coined phrase “structures of feeling” → how ideas shape culture and our emotional realities
    - “structures” shows that feelings don’t arise spontaneously and are structured by social position and the ideas and stories and values we’re exposed to
    - social structures aren’t just abstract things they work their way into us and express themselves through us
    - manifest as emotions passions and desires
    - in any slice of time you’re coexisting with past present and future just beginning to take place
    - residual (whats left over from past but still influential), dominant (whatever prevails in present and feels contemporary), emergent (new possibilities that haven’t become widespread but could become dominant in the future”

[Book 2] 2.2 Residual, Dominant, and Emerging Ideas on Childhood in Jane Eyre

- Jane Eyre residual ideas on childhood (from medieval christian europe but still circling)
    - people saw children as miniature adults
        - Jane articulates this
        - how she views children isn’t that distinct from how she views adults

        - pg 35 describing her cousins John Reed is bilious, Georgianna is vain, she tells John Reed he's like a murderer slave driver and roman emperor
    - all of the children have very adult flaws
    - children did not used to have distinctive clothing, adult clothes cut shorter
    - children were required to work as early as age 7
    - by 10 apprenticed to a trade, left family to life with person apprenticed to
    - industrial revolution fueled by child labor (mines, factories, etc)
    - controversial to say children could not be sent to work
    - Jane starts working as teacher at age 16
    - before 1800s even mansions of rich did not have separate rooms for children
    - pg 27 Mr. Lloyd says Jane is too old to mind being left at home, associates ghosts with babies
    - when Jane meets Adele she says she seems quite like a child → points to childhood as aristocrat
    - Rochester perceives Adele as "miniature adult" pg 156, petite version of her mother and ascribes all the same vices to her as to her mother
  - people viewed children as inherently evil until 1700s (original sin) → adults inherently evil and child not separate so not exempt, not free of sin until redeemed
    - pg 33 Mrs Reed looks at Jane as if she's unsure if she's child or fiend
    - Bessie tells Jane to think over her wickedness
    - pg 19 Jane worries that she is wicked
    - pg 16 Abbot warns Jane god will strike her in a tantrum
    - pg 39 Mr. Brocklehurst tells Jane she has a wicked heart, leaves her with a child's guide which narrates sudden death of naughty child

addicted to deceit
        - pg 75 Brocklehurst announces that Jane is servant of the devil
- Jane Eyre dominant ideas on childhood
    - children are deficient inferiors in need of discipline and training (dominant less residual)
        - less than adults
        - lacking crucial things but have potential to develop them
        - job of parents and teachers to acquire these qualities
        - this view of childhood coincides with take off of european imperialism
        - these concepts of childhood impact how colonizers see the native populations they conquer
        - savagery
        - became part of colonialism - like children native populations would need to be disciplined and trained to become adults
        - also began to think of children as somewhat savage - Bessie and John Reed talking about Jane as wild and dangerous
    - children as blank slates (John Locke Tabula Rasa)
        - children are not inherently bad or inherently anything just blank
        - focused on potential to become adults
        - child to be considered fully malleable
        - Locke's main point was that education would determine whether child turned out good or bad
        - Locke said childhood was developing/fragile state
        - parenting and education became more important than ideas about soul or sin
        - helping children learn good habits, to reason, control impulses
        - to become an adult need to learn to control feeling and impulses (conversations with friends too much control is seen as lack of

emotional maturity)

        - chapter 3 - from adult narrator - children can feel but cannot analyze their feelings
        - Rochester says Adele has shown improvement after months with Jane
        - Reason is not expected to be fully in child's power
        - Locke interested in positive reinforcement, role models, emulation (competition not about beating another person but raising yourself to their level)
        - Locke is dominant version of childhood in Jane Eyre
        - as educator Jane is kind and gentle
        - pg 122? my pupil was lively child who had been spoiled and bad education made her wayward but with Jane's improvement became obedient and teachable
        - where did Jane learn this gentle way of education → Miss Temple
- emergent ideas on childhood during Bronte's time
    - childhood (unlike adulthood) as a state of natural innocence and children as inherently good (Rousseau and romanticism)
        - Rochester describes his youth as innocence, might have been as good as you almost as stainless projecting purity onto Jane (calls her little girl after that)
    - childhood as a time of intense feeling, imagination, and special kind of freedom (capital R Romantic)
        - Helen Burns has hint of this - pg 65 visionary quality to her, daydreams of childhood home
        - often produces nostalgia for childhood - freedom of mind and mobility
        - when Jane wanders when everyone has Typhus wandering in woods pg 75 enjoying feeling fully free and unwatched → romantic idea of childhood (reaction against Locke who would advocate watching all the time to be molded)

        - pg 126 describes herself at 18 as maturing youth, what is it that it takes for Jane to mature in this novel?

[Book 2] 2.3 Recap of 1st Lecture

- What does childhood mean?
- Previously focused on what it means to enter adulthood but need to know where you're coming from
- Bildungsroman arose 100 years after people began to think of childhood and adulthood as distinct life stages
- Idea of childhood is that it is formative of who we are as adults
- Around 1800 Bildungsroman emerges as novel of development - tells the story of how children become adults
- Begs the question what changes in humans as we mature?
- Residual - from middle ages, children are miniature adults and therefore inherently evil and sinful, children are deficient adults - defined by lacking reason and self control that adults have, education is about breaking spirit of child and disciplining them
    - We know they are residual because these ideas get assigned to characters of dubious character and judgment
    - Mrs. Reed, Mr. Brocklehurst (pseudo villain characters)
    - Jane describes older cousins as miniature adults but she is only a child when she says this
    - This framework cannot produce a bildungsroman
- Emergent - Victorians writing between 1840s and 1880s came to associate childhood with angelic innocence
    - Angelic child also can't be protagonist of Bildungsroman because if already perfect can't develop
    - When people value innocence above all else it means they don't value maturation
        - They see maturation as a fall from grace

        - Catcher in the Rye - adults are phonies, holden's younger sister is golden standard for not growing up, innocence
    - Bronte rejected idea about children being totally innocent
    - Jane Eyre does not overvalue innocence - Rochester always tries to make her out to be an angel and she rejects it
- Dominant idea of childhood
    - Locke's idea of blank slate
    - children are impressionable (both Jane and Rochester find that Adele is easily improved by Jane's instruction) and that is what makes them educable
    - education should be gentle and kind
    - what you do to the clay and wax it will do to others (Jane treated kindly by Miss Temple and then goes on to treat Adele kindly)
    - with right education children learn impulse control and can become self governing

[Book 2] 2.4 Jane's Self: how Child Self Connects to Adult Self

- Romantics writing between 1780s and 1820s thought childhood was special time of imagination freedom and closeness to nature, best time of life that you long to return to and try to keep alive
- Bronte loved romantic poets
- Adult Jane definitely not nostalgic for her childhood
- Jane's self is not a fully integrated self (comes back to this later)
- When describing end of time at Lowood Jane describes how through Miss Temple's guidance she becomes quiet and dutiful
    - But still evidence of not fully integrated self, she describes her thoughts as inmates, says she "believed" herself content, and other people perceived her as dutiful
- **What is else is going on inside Jane? and what does Jane want from adulthood? what does she want her adult self to be?**

- My thoughts
  - She wants to see more of the world (says so after discussing Miss Temple departure)
  - She wants excitement (excited when she hears Thornfield is near big town she wants to be near big town)
  - She wants something different from what she has known (mentions having only seen Lowood and Gateshall)
  - But she wants to be around kindness and honor and virtuous people as well (wants to make sure Mrs Fairfax has a good household)
- What others said she wants:
  - Freedom, self-determination, independence, to be taken seriously, autonomy, mutual dependence, agency, excitement, love, security
- Jane articulates a wish for radical mobility and freedom
- Jane also says she'd be willing to settle for servitude (governess) to be financially independent
- Jane yearns for freedom and independence but also keeps calling Rochester her master and seems hyper submissive
- She asserts her autonomy by adhering to limits on freedom and desire imposed by religion and law

- Jane's yearning for mobility and freedom - chapter 12, been at Thornfield for a while and Rochester hasn't appeared yet pg 123
  - Points out how Adele has become obedient and teachable and made reasonable progress (Lockean)
  - Jane is finding herself a bit ungovernable and excessive
  - She climbs up to the roof already breaking a bit from protocol
  - "the restlessness was in my nature"
  - discusses how women are supposed to be calm but they also need action - then hears Grace Poole laugh

    - starts out fairly modest (meet new people see new place) but by next place associates that with revolt rebellion and feminist claims
    - lot of critics characterize this as feminist bildungsroman - if it is it must be liberal feminism not radical feminism
    - the novel is committed to liberalism more broadly - Maria is willing to live outside the law, Jane is not nor does she want to change the law
    - this is not the key moment in understanding what Jane wants from life (it is not revolt and rebellion that she wants)
    - in a way this novel is presenting gender neutral bildung - not that different from rochester's
- how do we reconcile independence and dependence?
    - Reed Sisters:
        - Eliza wants to be completely independent and indebted to no one 262
        - Georgianna wants to be completely dependent and to fasten her feablesness
        - Jane wants to be somewhere in between
- reason vs feeling
- feel for yourself vs feel for others
- Jane's return to Gateshead
    - When Jane returns to her Aunt Reed's house she and Reed take the measure of how much she's changed
    - pg 253 Jane is not resentful anymore
    - everything we see here when she returns is contrasted with ungovernable excitement in chapter 4 - she wants to learn to govern herself
    - pg 42 when Jane is telling Mrs Reed everything, narrator bumped off, you want to cheer her on but her freedom is unrestrained and ungovernable and it becomes clear narrator and Bronte don't think this is the goal
    - main thing different when Jane comes back is self control

    - pg 256 - vengeance quelled, returns with no emotion besides compassion and desire to forget and forgive, Mrs Reed unchanged and unchangeable but Jane is unchanged
    - independent different from liberty - important distinction
        - liberty implies freedom from all restriction, to do as one likes whenever you want
        - independence is being free of the control of others but implies control over oneself, free of control of others because you are in control of yourself
- pg 351 Jane's decision - would like to do what Rochester wants her to do but Rochester says "all i'm asking you to do is to transgress a mere human law"
    - Jane says the more solitary she is the more self respect she will have for herself and feels she must resist temptation and follow law
    - Jane says if at her wish she breaks laws (liberty) they will have no worth
    - Jane pledges allegiance to laws
    - Rochester is like the Maria of the story, wants to live outside the law
    - Jane doesn't think the laws are great ("preconceived opinions") but wants to keep to them ("there I plant my foot") - staccato, one syllable, sounds like what its describing sound wise, wants to be tethered or planted to standard conventions
    - liberal idea of adulthood as self control
    - Jane is self determining enough to understand she just needs to follow the rules
- **real bildung moments are after forgiving aunt and also 351 telling Rochester must follow law**
- term liberal -
    - liberals believe in importance of state and civil society
    - believe in certain notion of order and stability

- not socialist and not communist, don’t emphasize collective, believe in individual autonomy and private property
- 19th century liberals associated with reform (expanding who could vote, freedom of thought and debate, also believe in system and the law, not trying to overturn or escape)
- liberals designate certain people as being outside the system of people who can govern themselves

[Book 2] 2.5 Recap of 2nd Lecture

- Return to Gateshead
  - Self control is antithesis of childhood self
  - Charting difference between character Jane and Narrator Jane (30 year old)
  - Autobiography is always about how person came to be person who could write their autobiography
  - Jane overcame behavior of first volume - “acting save” in forgiving aunt shows that she is becoming civilized
- Leaving Rochester instead of becoming mistress
  - Other adult moment is leaving Rochester instead of becoming his mistress - language soaked in selfhood - I care for myself, respecting myself - clear that the decision she is making is crucial to selfhood
  - Jane opts for independence rather than liberty
  - Liberty vs independence
    - Liberty - doing whatever you want, Jane calls it “individual convenience”, it is tempting to Jane as she desires Rochester (moment when it makes clear she is in an English novel and not a French one)
      - “adhere to law and principle” even though “body and soul rise in mutiny”
      - “here I plant my foot” - wants to become rooted to foundation of the law, assertion of selfhood - constructing herself

        - seems paradoxical that independence = following the law, if she chose liberty she would end up subjugated by her desires, wouldn't be her realizing what she wants, she would be swept up with it
        - choosing to follow the law is asserting selfhood and protecting herself from being swept up
        - also will be at whims of Rochester if she chooses to go with him, no control
        - Jane does not want to identify herself with her passion and desire, people saw those things as ephemeral and inconsistent, antithetical to reason and self-interest
- Contrast with Conversations with Friends
    - Frances has to learn how to feel, learn, and accept and share her feelings
    - Jane needs to learn how to not succumb to her feelings
- Liberalism
    - when Jane chooses to follow law she does as Miss Temple would have, demonstrates that good habits, role model, discipline paid off and she achieved it

[Book 2] 2.6 Liberalism, Independence, Orientalism

- Jane aspires to assert liberal, reasonable, independent selfhood (does not seen marriage as a compromise as she comes into marriage with family and fortune)
- Communal bildung built into novel with sharing of inheritance
- Part of why she has to leave Rochester is she desires him but it is complicated, part of desire is to submit to him, be overwhelmed by him, keeps calling him her master
- It should seem weird (not normal)
- She wants to surrender herself to absolute ruler, a master
- Not consistent, she also asserts equality with Rochester

- pg 281 first time she says she's going to leave when she thinks he's marrying Ingram, she says she is a free human being with independent will
- Rochester also sometimes asserts that he and Jane are equals (282 during proposal)
- No sense that Jane just wants to surrender to any man (will not submit to St John because he will crush her)
- Not that she doesn't wan to be a servant just not his servant
- Choice is important to her sense of selfhood and development - often bends to higher authority (Rochester or the law) but she still wants to choose
- When she calls Rochester "my master" the my is equally important, possessive master who she is asserting that she is choosing to serve him in particular
- Even though Jane keeps calling him "my master" she dislikes it when he treats her "like a slave"
- She wants to choose a master without herself becoming a slave
- Whenever she feels Rochester is becoming too masterful she takes a step towards independence
    - When she thinks she's falling in love with someone who is falling for someone else she decides to advertise for new governess position
    - When she feels Rochester treating her like a slave, not consulting her tastes buying her things, she writes to her uncle (significant he is buying gold chains)
        - She imagines uncle might give her a "small independency"
    - Says she will continue working as Adele's governess to keep her own lodging
    - Fantasy of freeing slaves as Christian missionary, in liberal charter
        - Jane has gone from slave → liberator
        - what she's doing is outsourcing slaveishness onto other figures and mastery onto sultan figure

        - projecting her own situation onto racialized others
- Stigmatization and dehumanization of people in the middle east → Orientalism by Edward Said
    - charts how Europeans believed everything middle east did was opposite of norm
    - crude process of casting european christians as norm and non europeans and non christians as excessive and deficient at the same time
    - casts people from “the orient” as childlike, savage, uncivilized
    - middle eastern stereotype - imprisoning women as sexual slaves
    - orientalism undos differences between vastly different places (India and Egypt)
- Rochester’s song - about future wife dying with him
    - trope of love so strong can’t survive without each other
    - Jane sharply questions him about this “pagan” idea, says she has no intention of dying with him
    - References Hindu custom of widows throwing themselves on husband funeral pyre
    - Often used as British justification of colonialism over India → saving women
- End of chapter - future husband coming between her and religion, could not see god
    - Idol - term for false god, associated with paganism
    - Here she is embracing paganism she had so clearly rejected, she is afraid she is becoming pagan
    - When she says “in those days” she is marking difference between who she was then (she had to outgrow turning Rochester into idol) and now
        - just like conversations with friends “back then I was always thinking about rich people”
- What she really needs to do is liberate herself

[Book 2] 2.7 Mad Woman in the Attic

- Bertha is little reason Jane doesn't become Mrs. Rochester
- When Jane is thinking about saving these women, it's Bertha the mad woman who saves Jane
- Jane worried that Rochester wants to enslave woman → has kept his wife locked up
- For much of the novel we think that the person who turns out to be Bertha is Grace Poole
- The Madwoman in the Attic (as a figure) - associated with confused identities, not matching up with who they seem to be
- Jane calls Grace Poole living enigma
- What is that mystery?
- What does Bertha function in novel tell us about Jane's development?
- Mad woman in attic is more of a function that anyone can plug into rather than a person
- It could be anyone...
- pg 172 - Grace Poole seems too normal to commit violence and laugh weirdly
- Creates environment suggesting maybe plain Jane is not as normal as she appears to be
- Grace Poole asks Jane on nighttime habits, Jane calls Grace fiendish, which is exactly how she perceived herself and how Mrs. Reed perceived herself
- Idea that Grace Poole stands for - underneath calm cool exterior fiendish woman might burst out
- 1 reading - mad woman is Jane's double, she represents everything Jane wants to push aside but can't fully repress, persuasive when you think about when exactly the mad woman appears (structural reading)
    - when does jane first hear Grace Poole laugh → right after moment of rebellious spirit on the roof

- second time → chapter 15, Rochester just told Jane about affair with Adele's mother and Jane is acknowledge to herself that she is becoming attached to him and worries, later that night hears the sounds and bursts into Rochester's room, finds tongues of flame
    - words used to describe mad woman's laugh link it to repression
    - bed in flames represents Jane passionate emotions
    - emotions are dangerous because she assumes they are not reciprocated and they compromise her autonomy
    - so she is both mad woman and person who douses the flames in water
- 3rd appearance → attack of Mr Mason
    - whats been happening before this is that Rochester has been forcing Jane watch him flirt with Miss Ingram and then out comes madwoman
    - "savage and thrilling" vs "savage and high" which was Jane talking to Mrs Reed
    - homonyms with her name appear twice in proximity to mad woman
- last appearance chapter 25 (just before wedding) Jane is nervous about wedding
    - up pops the mad woman to rip bridal veil in half
    - read as expressing Jane's ambivalence about becoming Jane Rochester
    - not subtle

- problems with that account - as Jane's double we can't get the sense of what the reason is for Jane's missionary impulses → another way of reading this is as the "other"
    - missionary doesn't assert affinity with those they seek to convert
    - missionary begins from position of asserting radical difference between missionary and pagan
    - missionary positions themselves as having power that people they are trying to convert don't have, power of salvation

- wants to use that power to free people by saving them
- Bertha isn't just Jane's double, she has to die for Jane to get what she wants
- no integration of two figures, more of Jane's opponent, antithesis, or rival
- underscored by what happens on 2 occasions when Jane sees Bertha
  - 1st occasion is with mirror
  - 2nd - pg 325, Jane projecting aspects of herself onto racialized others
    - "figure ran" "what it was whether beast or human being one could not tell" "snatched and growled" "covered with clothing and quantity of dark grizzled hair"
    - "clothed hyena rose up"
    - "maniac bellowed, parted shaggy locks"
    - "I recognized purple face and bloated features"
    - "big woman"
    - bind her to a chair as Jane was in red room
    - Jane dehumanizes Bertha
    - Jane sees no resemblance between herself and Bertha
- Rochester links Bertha's madness to creole background (actual race is not explained) but presented as having been tainted by living outside England
  - whiteness degenerates into something not white
- Jane represents a white femininity that is at risk of being corrupted but will be preserved
- **the other is what the self must reject in order to fully become itself**
- other is reduced to an object so that someone else can become a sovereign subject
- clear that what Bertha represents is excessive liberty - liberty run wild, too much passion, too much desire, too strong
- in relation to the 'other' Jane can position herself as sovereign

    - unlike Bertha Jane will show she has earned the right to govern others because she can govern herself
- lots of connections to imperialism in book
    - mahogany
    - missionary St John
    - Rochester wife fortune in Jamaica
- we can see arc of Jane's bildung - Jane becomes an adult by gaining empire over herself
    - and some of the way she gains control over herself is through imperialized other
    - wealth
- liberal feminist novel - ultimately Bronte is trying to suggest that legal marriage can be reconciled with equality between man and woman
    - at the end Jane insists that she is not compromising herself for marriage
    - Jane finds a way for Jane reconciling desire and the law
    - along the way she has to create others who seem to exist only to facilitate her development and have to be eliminated for her to achieve bildung

Book 1: Père Goriot

- What counts in the world of Balzac is what can be counted → material externals, rankings of neighborhoods all mapped onto geography of Paris
- Very different world from Goethe
- Goethe concept of communal bildung - even aristocrats value that
- Balzac's world is anti communal and radically individualistic, based on rankings and climbing up past one another
- Balzac's world rewards a kind of power of taking and not sharing
- Goethe doesn't believe in equal sharing of power but that those with more power should share a little

- Balzac sees capitalism as zero sum game
- Goriot at the beginning seems like an exception to this zero sum game but by the end of the novel we learn he has been generous to his daughters because he sees them as his property “I made them”
- Vautrin’s ultimate goal is to turn people into property → become slave owner
- Is capitalist bildung actually bildung? quite possibly not, rising and falling being in constant flux is not the same as growing and developing, those imply some stabilization although not stasis, to treat yourself and others as objects is not bildung because dehumanizing
- Bildungsroman often about realizing your ambition and making your mark on the world
- Pere Goriot raises questions about how to develop in a world based on competition and ranking
- Is there a way to thrive in capitalist society without engaging in cynicism

1.1 Mobility

- Pre-revolution: caste system where you can’t change which category you are in
- Post-revolution: volatile society, you can fall more easily
    - Rising is difficult one way Vautrin comes up with a way is to kill someone
    - Balzac is showing what it takes to improve position
- Nobility still has value on its own but not a lot - need money, only good if you can turn it into money
- Capitalism - many more people fall than rise, inequality but people aren’t fixed in positions
- “The point I made in lecture was about flux: characters hope to rise but this is a world defined by rising and falling, not by unilateral upward mobility.”